

CLAT Express - May 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

UAE Visit Outcomes Check

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the United Arab Emirates focused on energy security, defence, technology and investment. Energy was a central theme, with an Indian strategic reserves company signing a memorandum of understanding with Abu Dhabi National Oil Company for strategic collaboration. Talks also covered storing crude oil at Fujairah under India's Overseas Strategic Reserve Framework. Separately, Indian Oil Corporation and ADNOC signed a strategic collaboration agreement on LPG supply security, and a long-term LPG sale agreement was under consideration.

On defence and maritime matters, the framework for a Strategic Defence Partnership was advanced. A memorandum between Cochin Shipyard and Drydocks World aims to establish a ship repair cluster at Vadinar. Cooperation also includes offshore fabrication under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme.

In technology, a term sheet was signed for setting up supercomputing clusters, linked to India's AI Mission and a partnership between C-DAC and G42. Investment was also on the agenda, as two institutions agreed to explore investments in India's infrastructure sector.

Taken together, these outcomes show how India's partnership with the UAE now extends well beyond trade into petroleum security, shipbuilding, artificial intelligence and infrastructure finance. Several arrangements were signed, while others remain at the stage of proposals or discussions.

Q1.

Who is the Prime Minister of the UAE according to the booklet?

- (A) Sheikh Khalifa bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (B) Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (C) Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (D) Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum

Q2.

Which facility is described in the booklet as the world's largest airport terminal?

- (A) Abu Dhabi International Airport
- (B) Jebel Ali Port
- (C) Barakah Nuclear Power Plant
- (D) Al Maktoum International Airport

Q3.

How many of the following statements about the UAE are correct?

- I. The UAE signed a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with India in 2022.
 - II. Indian nationals form the largest expatriate community within the UAE.
 - III. Al Maktoum International Airport is located in Abu Dhabi.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

How many barrels of ADNOC crude oil did India propose to store in its Strategic Petroleum Reserves?

- (A) 10 million barrels
- (B) 20 million barrels
- (C) 50 million barrels
- (D) 30 million barrels

Q5.

Assertion (A): The UAE is the only nation participating in India's Strategic Reserve Programme.

Reason (R): The UAE accounted for 18% of India's remittance flows.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the UAE:

- I. The UAE is India's 3rd largest supplier of LNG.
- II. The UAE is India's 2nd largest crude oil source.
- III. The UAE is India's 2nd largest export destination, after the US.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Which of the following is the naval component named in the booklet's list of UAE defence cooperation?

- (A) Al Dhafra Air Base
- (B) Desert Cyclone
- (C) Desert Eagle
- (D) Zayed Talwar

Q8.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Trade between India and UAE in FY 2025-26	A. Up to US\$ 1 billion
II. UAE share of India's remittance flows	B. 30 million barrels
III. Investment explored by ADIA and NIIF	C. 18%
IV. Proposed ADNOC crude storage in India	D. US\$ 100 billion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

OPEC and the UAE Exit: MCQ Set

Oil-producing countries have long coordinated their output so that crude prices do not swing too sharply. When prices fall too low, exporters that depend on petroleum revenue lose income, and when supply runs ahead of demand, the market can become oversupplied. Recently the United

Arab Emirates announced that it would leave the producer group and its wider alliance with other oil exporters, a move seen as a major geopolitical shift. Collective decisions by the group have traditionally helped it shape global oil prices, so the departure of a large producer may reduce that influence. Member countries have different national priorities and economic needs, which can make agreement on output levels difficult even within a well-established group. Such limits are usually set by agreement among members. Output quotas were one reason behind the exit, because they limited how fully the UAE could use its expanding capacity. The booklet also points to growing competition among producers, including rivalry between the UAE and a major regional neighbour. The episode matters for importing countries such as India as well, since lower prices could ease their import bills while greater volatility could make long-term budgeting harder. Taken together, the exit shows how energy markets, regional politics and national economic goals are closely linked.

Q1.

Where is the headquarters of OPEC located?

- (A) Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
- (B) Brussels, Belgium
- (C) Geneva, Switzerland
- (D) Vienna, Austria

Q2.

OPEC was established at which conference?

- (A) Bandung Conference
- (B) Vienna Conference
- (C) Geneva Conference
- (D) Baghdad Conference

Q3.

Consider the following statements about OPEC:

- I. Ecuador was suspended from OPEC in 1992.
- II. All OPEC member countries are signatories to the UNFCCC.
- III. Ecuador rejoined OPEC in 1992.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q4.

Which of the following was NOT a founding member of OPEC?

- (A) UAE
- (B) Iraq
- (C) Iran
- (D) Venezuela

Q5.

Assertion (A): The UAE's exit reduces OPEC's collective ability to control global oil prices.

Reason (R): The UAE is a major oil producer.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UAE aims to reach about 5 million barrels per day by 2027.
- II. The UAE holds the world's 6th largest oil reserves.
- III. Russia was the world's largest oil producer in 2022.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Peak Oil Theory	A. Connects Habshan to Fujairah
II. OPEC Fund for International Development	B. Proposed by M. King Hubbert
III. OPEC+ alliance	C. Established in 1976
IV. Habshan-Fujairah Pipeline	D. Formed in 2016

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q8.

Which country terminated its OPEC membership in January 1995?

- (A) Gabon
- (B) Libya
- (C) Nigeria
- (D) Ecuador

Panel recommendations check

Exam malpractice damages more than one test. When the credibility of the system falls, the market value of degrees and merit rankings can fall with it. Re-conducting a compromised examination also places a heavy financial burden on government institutions, and large-scale cheating makes parents and students lose confidence in educational fairness. Students are hit too. Cancellations delay admissions, and honest candidates face stress and demotivation.

After the NEET-UG 2024 controversy, the Ministry of Education set up a high-level committee. Its major recommendations address the functioning of the testing agency and the way examinations are conducted. The panel proposed limiting the role of the National Testing Agency to entrance examinations, and it suggested a technology-enabled authentication system. It also called for governance reforms through an empowered governing body, and for more secure examination centres. Over time, the panel suggested that future entrance examinations move gradually towards computer adaptive testing.

Q1.

How many new posts did the panel recommend creating for administration, IT infrastructure and digital security?

- (A) Five
- (B) Fifty
- (C) Twenty
- (D) Ten

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Governance reforms	A. Computer Adaptive Testing
II. Institutional restructuring	B. Technology-enabled authentication system
III. Digi-Exam framework	C. Empowered governing body with sub-committees
IV. Shift towards online examinations	D. Creation of 10 new posts

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the panel's recommendations:

- I. The panel recommended an empowered governing body with dedicated sub-committees.
- II. The panel recommended that private coaching institutes be used as examination centres.
- III. The panel proposed gradual adoption of Computer Adaptive Testing for future entrance examinations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the panel's recommendations are correct?

- I. The NTA should focus only on entrance examinations for higher education institutions.
- II. The panel proposed creating 10 new posts for administration, IT infrastructure and digital security.
- III. The panel recommended an empowered governing body with dedicated sub-committees.
- IV. The panel recommended that the NTA conduct recruitment examinations.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

How many sub-committees did the panel recommend for the empowered governing body?

- (A) Five
- (B) Two
- (C) Four
- (D) Three

Q6.

For which institutions did the panel propose limiting the NTA's role to entrance examinations?

- (A) Higher education institutions
- (B) Schools
- (C) State governments
- (D) Private coaching centres

Q7.

The panel's proposed technology-enabled authentication system is similar to which existing system?

- (A) DigiLocker
- (B) UPI
- (C) Aadhaar
- (D) Digi-Yatra

Court ruling: legal reasoning

The Madhya Pradesh High Court has ruled on the Bhojshala - Kamal Maula Complex, a medieval monument in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh. Relying on findings from a survey by the Archaeological Survey of India, the court declared the complex a Hindu temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi, another name for Saraswati. In the same ruling, the court quashed an earlier ASI order that had allowed shared worship at the site. The bench held that the Places of Worship Act, 1991 could not be applied here, because the site is a protected monument under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958. The freeze on religious character in the Act does not extend to such monuments. The Muslim side had relied on a proclamation issued by the princely State of Dhar in 1935. The bench rejected this reliance, noting that the Government of India Act, 1935, on which the proclamation rested, had not been enforced until a later date. The case was treated as a writ petition seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship, unlike the Babri Masjid dispute, which was a title suit about ownership. To balance the rights of both communities, the court directed the State Government to consider applications for allotting alternative land within Dhar for a mosque or prayer site.

Q1.

Which section of the Places of Worship Act, 1991 excludes ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958 from the religious character freeze provision?

- (A) Section 4(3)
- (B) Section 4(1)
- (C) Section 3
- (D) Section 6

Q2.

The Government of India Act, 1935, on which the Dhar proclamation rested, was not enforced until when?

- (A) August 1935
- (B) August 1947
- (C) January 1950
- (D) April 1937

Q3.

Under which article was the Bhojshala case treated as a writ petition seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship?

- (A) Article 14
- (B) Article 25
- (C) Article 32
- (D) Article 226

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 3	A. Religious identity same as on 15 August 1947
II. Section 4(1)	B. Exempts ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958
III. Section 5	C. Maximum 3 years imprisonment and fines
IV. Section 6	D. Prohibits conversion of a place of worship

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- A. The 2003 ASI order allowing shared worship was quashed.
- B. The Babri Masjid dispute was treated as a writ petition.
- C. The bench accepted the 1935 proclamation of Dhar as valid.
- D. The findings relied upon came from a 2024 survey by the ASI.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Under which government was the Places of Worship Act, 1991 passed?

- (A) Janata Dal-led National Front government
- (B) Atal Bihari Vajpayee-led NDA government
- (C) Manmohan Singh-led UPA government
- (D) P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government

Expansion of the Supreme Court Bench

The Supreme Court of India sits at the apex of the country's judicial system and is described as the final interpreter and guardian of the Constitution. It began functioning in the early months of 1950 and took over the role of the highest court of appeal that the British Privy Council had earlier held. The Court's strength is not fixed in the Constitution; it can be changed by law, and it has grown over the years from its original size. The Union Cabinet has now approved a bill to enlarge the bench further. The government's aim is to tackle the Court's growing caseload, which has led to a massive backlog of cases. A bigger bench is expected to speed up the disposal of cases and improve timely delivery of justice in constitutional and civil matters. It would also make it easier to constitute constitution benches, special benches and larger benches for important cases. Such an expansion is seen as a way of strengthening judicial capacity. The amendment bill must pass through both Houses of Parliament before it can take effect, and it also needs the President's assent. Judges of the Court are appointed by the President, and the Constitution sets out the organisation, independence, jurisdiction and powers of the Court in detail.

Q1.

The Union Cabinet approved a bill to expand the Supreme Court to how many judges, counting the Chief Justice of India?

- (A) 36
- (B) 42
- (C) 40
- (D) 38

Q2.

Assertion (A): Parliament can increase the number of judges of the Supreme Court by law.

Reason (R): Article 124 of the Constitution empowers Parliament to increase the number of Supreme Court judges by law.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Justice Soumitra Sen (2011)	A. Resigned before impeachment proceedings could be initiated
II. Justice Ramaswami (1993)	B. Motion failed due to lack of signatures
III. Justice C. V. Nagarjuna (2017)	C. Motion failed as Lok Sabha abstained from voting
IV. PD Dinakaran (2011)	D. Impeached in Rajya Sabha but resigned before Lok Sabha discussion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Supreme Court of India:

- I. The Chief Justice of India is appointed by the President after consulting such judges as he deems necessary.
- II. A Supreme Court judge holds office until attaining the age of 65 years.
- III. A Supreme Court judge is removed by the President on the recommendation of the Union Cabinet.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Supreme Court of India are correct?

- I. It was inaugurated on 26 January 1950.
- II. It originally had eight judges, including the Chief Justice.
- III. It succeeded the Federal Court of India.
- IV. Its advisory opinion is binding on the President.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Under Article 127, before the CJI appoints a High Court judge as an ad hoc judge of the Supreme Court, whose previous consent is required in addition to consultation with that High Court's Chief Justice?

- (A) President of India
- (B) Union Minister of Law and Justice
- (C) Attorney General of India
- (D) Prime Minister

Q7.

Articles 124 to 147, which deal with the organisation, independence, jurisdiction and powers of the Supreme Court, are placed in which Part of the Constitution?

- (A) Part 3
- (B) Part 4
- (C) Part 6
- (D) Part 5

Q8.

Which judge was NOT superseded when AN Ray was appointed Chief Justice of India in 1973?

- (A) JM Shelat
- (B) KS Hegde
- (C) AN Grover
- (D) HR Khanna

Mergers, Exceptions and Member Categories

The anti-defection framework exists to discourage legislators from switching sides. The rules sit in a schedule of the Constitution and cover members of both Parliament and State legislatures. Their aim is to keep governments stable and to make legislators accountable for their conduct. Not every departure is treated the same way, however. The law treats independent members and nominated members differently, depending on when they choose to join a party. Political parties enforce discipline through whips, which direct members how to vote, and the law links defiance of those whips to possible loss of membership. The framework also allows whole groups of members to combine with another party under certain conditions, a feature critics say can encourage large-scale movement between parties. Decisions on these cases are taken by the presiding officer of each house, and courts review those decisions in limited ways. Judges have stressed that such decisions should not be delayed indefinitely, while commentators continue to question whether presiding officers can act impartially when they belong to the ruling party. The debate reflects a wider tension between stable government and the independence that individual legislators may want to exercise.

Q1.

The Anti-Defection Law is enshrined in which Schedule of the Indian Constitution?

- (A) 10th Schedule
- (B) 9th Schedule
- (C) 8th Schedule
- (D) 11th Schedule

Q2.

Assertion (A): Independent members can be disqualified for joining a party after their election.

Reason (R): Independent members can join a party at any time without penalty.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act (1985)	A. Removed the split provision
II. 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003)	B. Decisions ideally within 3 months
III. Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)	C. Phrase linked to party-switching in the 1960s
IV. Aaya Ram Gaya Ram	D. Introduced the Anti-Defection Law

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Anti-Defection Law:

- I. The Chairman of Rajya Sabha decides disqualification petitions of Rajya Sabha members.
- II. Members are not disqualified if two-thirds of a legislature party agree to merge with another party.
- III. The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003) allowed one-third of members to split without disqualification.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Anti-Defection Law are correct?

- I. Nominated members are disqualified if they join a party after six months of nomination.
 - II. Decisions on disqualification should ideally be made within six months.
 - III. A legislator who is declared of unsound mind by a court can be disqualified.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q6.

Under which Articles of the Constitution can a legislator be disqualified on general grounds?

- (A) Articles 100(1) and 189(1)
- (B) Articles 105(1) and 194(1)
- (C) Articles 110(1) and 199(1)
- (D) Articles 102(1) and 191(1)

Q7.

How does the Anti-Defection Law curtail legislative freedom?

- (A) It restricts members from voting independently and expressing dissent in the legislature
- (B) It bans members from speaking in Parliament without party approval
- (C) It prevents members from joining parliamentary committees
- (D) It bars members from raising private member bills

Q8.

Under the Anti-Defection Law, which exception applies when a legislator votes against the party whip?

- (A) If the Supreme Court grants a stay
- (B) If the Speaker approves the deviation beforehand
- (C) If at least half the party members support the action
- (D) If prior permission is taken or the party condones the action within 15 days

Reserves Under Pressure

India's foreign exchange reserves have come under visible pressure in recent months, and this has raised concern about the country's external position. The reserves are external assets held by the Reserve Bank of India, and they act as a buffer when the economy faces outside shocks. They also help the country pay for essential goods such as crude oil and fertilisers. When inflows of foreign currency exceed outflows, the balance of payments strengthens the reserves and supports the rupee. When outflows rise, the reserves can shrink and the currency can weaken. Several forces added to the outflows in 2026. Crude oil prices have been volatile, which raises the energy import bill. Demand for gold imports has also reached record levels. The central bank has been active in the market, intervening to defend a rupee that was weakening. The Prime Minister has urged citizens to limit non-essential spending on gold purchases, overseas travel and fuel. The aim is to protect currency stability and reduce capital outflows. Experts caution, however, that overly strict controls could stifle manufacturing and broader economic growth. They argue that the country must protect its financial security without damaging its industrial base, and balancing these two goals is the central challenge for policymakers in the months ahead.

Q1.

Which rank does India hold among the world's gold consumers, according to the booklet?

- (A) 2nd largest
- (B) Largest
- (C) 3rd largest
- (D) 4th largest

Q2.

What share of its crude oil requirement does India import, according to the booklet?

- (A) About 58%
- (B) About 69%
- (C) About 75%
- (D) About 89%

Q3.

Which of the following is NOT a component of India's Foreign Exchange Reserves?

- (A) Domestic government securities
- (B) Foreign currency assets
- (C) Gold reserves
- (D) Special Drawing Rights

Q4.

Which statement describes the 'Protectionism Trap' in the context of excessive forex conservation?

- (A) Excessive tariffs lead to WTO disputes and trade sanctions
- (B) Foreign companies exit the Indian market, reducing competition
- (C) Import restrictions increase input costs, reducing export competitiveness
- (D) Domestic companies become dependent on government subsidies

Q5.

Assertion (A): Household gold imports widen India's current account deficit.

Reason (R): Household gold imports add to productive capacity in the same way as sovereign reserves do.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Gold consumer rank	A. Gold accounts for about 9% of total imports
II. Crude oil import share	B. Rise of USD 1.5 to 2 billion in the import bill
III. Gold share of total imports	C. 2nd largest gold consumer globally
IV. Effect of a USD 1 rise in oil price	D. About 89% of crude oil requirement imported

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the effects of excessive forex conservation:

- I. Restricted imports of capital goods, semiconductors and raw materials can lower industrial output.
- II. Private consumption is a minor component of GDP, so suppressing it has little effect on growth.
- III. Capital control concerns can raise the country risk premium and dampen FDI and portfolio inflows.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

How many of the following statements about India's forex reserves and imports are correct?

- I. Forex reserves declined by nearly USD 38 billion within two months before May 2026.
- II. Imported urea and ammonia prices have roughly doubled.
- III. Foreign investors are attracted to economies that lack strong domestic demand.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Rankings and Key Findings 2026

Reporters Without Borders (RSF) has released the World Press Freedom Index 2026, the 24th edition of its annual report. The Index measures the level of freedom available to journalists in each country and region, and this year it covers 180 countries. Rankings are shaped by legal protections, the diversity of media outlets and the extent of political interference. Each country receives a score on a fixed scale, and the results show sharp contrasts. Some states remain at the top of the table, while others sit at the bottom with severe restrictions on reporters. Between these extremes, many countries have moved up or down because of changes in government or pressure on news organisations. Regions also differ greatly, and journalists in some parts of the world face far greater danger than others. The national questionnaire behind the Index asks experts about the political, legal, economic, social and security environment in each country. Its findings suggest that a free press is closely linked to informed public debate in any society.

Q1.

For how many consecutive years had Norway been top-ranked in the 2026 Index?

- (A) Five
- (B) Seven
- (C) Ten
- (D) Twelve

Q2.

What score did Norway receive in the World Press Freedom Index 2026?

- (A) 88.92
- (B) 97.20
- (C) 82.27
- (D) 92.72

Q3.

What percentage of countries face 'Difficult' or 'Very Serious' conditions for journalism?

- (A) 32.5 per cent
- (B) 42.8 per cent
- (C) 52.2 per cent
- (D) 61.4 per cent

Q4.

Assertion (A): Global press freedom has declined in 2026.

Reason (R): A majority of countries face 'Difficult' or 'Very Serious' conditions for journalism.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Syria	A. Rank 157th with score 31.96
II. Niger	B. Sharpest rise after political transition
III. India	C. Second-highest score at 88.92
IV. Netherlands	D. Steepest ranking fall due to military rule

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the World Press Freedom Index 2026:

- I. Norway was top-ranked for the 10th consecutive year.
- II. Only 1 per cent of the world's population lives in countries rated 'Good' for journalism.
- III. Syria's ranking fell sharply after its political transition.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the World Press Freedom Index 2026 are correct?

- I. The index covers 150 countries and regions.
- II. Norway topped the index for 10 consecutive years.
- III. India ranked 151st in 2026.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

Which country was ranked second in the World Press Freedom Index 2026?

- (A) Netherlands
- (B) Estonia
- (C) Denmark
- (D) Sweden

LEADS basics check

Logistics performance across India's States and Union Territories is measured through LEADS, a national index that benchmarks each State and UT on common parameters. The report is prepared by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, which works under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The seventh edition, released as the LEADS 2025 Report, evaluated States and UTs on parameters such as infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment and data-driven logistics reforms. The report is presented across several logistics-related categories. The 2025 edition also changed how results are classified. In place of the earlier three-tier model, it introduced a four-tier system, and States and UTs are now sorted into new groups. Excellence and innovation in the sector are recognised through a separate set of awards called LEAPS, which were conferred alongside the report. The LEADS framework takes inspiration from an international

benchmark, the Logistics Performance Index of the World Bank. That global index analyses differences between countries in customs procedures, logistics costs and infrastructure quality. The national and global tools therefore differ in scope, since one compares States and UTs within India while the other compares countries.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about LEADS 2025:

- I. The LEADS Report is prepared by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade.
- II. LEADS was launched in 2015.
- III. The 2025 edition uses a four-tier classification system.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

How many of the following statements about LEADS are correct?

- 1. LEADS stands for Logistics Ease Across Different States.
- 2. LEADS was launched in 2020.
- 3. LEADS draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index.
- 4. LEADS is prepared by the Ministry of Railways.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q3.

In which year was LEADS launched?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2020

Q4.

Across how many logistics-related categories is the LEADS 2025 Report presented?

- (A) 9
- (B) 11
- (C) 17
- (D) 13

Q5.

Assertion (A): The LEADS framework draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index.

Reason (R): The World Bank's Logistics Performance Index is reported every two years.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

What does LEAPS stand for?

- (A) Logistics Excellence, Advancement and Performance Shield
- (B) Logistics Evaluation and Achievement Performance System
- (C) Logistics Efficiency, Advancement and Progress Shield
- (D) Logistics Enablement and Performance Standards

Q7.

The LEADS 2025 release is linked to which two national initiatives?

- (A) PM GatiShakti and National Logistics Policy 2022
- (B) Make in India and Digital India
- (C) Digital India and Startup India
- (D) Swachh Bharat and Smart Cities Mission

Pokhran and the 1998 milestones

National Technology Day is observed every year on 11 May. The day commemorates technological achievements reached on 11 May 1998, when several milestones were reached. One of these was a series of nuclear tests conducted at the Pokhran Test Range in Rajasthan. India had earlier carried out a nuclear test at the same range, and the 1998 tests marked a major step in the country's scientific history. Students preparing for current affairs should be clear about the sequence of these events, the people who led them, and the names given to the operations. The 1998 tests were not the only technological milestones of that day. Another was the first successful test flight of the Hansa-3 aircraft, which marked progress in indigenous aviation. The Defence Research and Development Organisation also carried out a test of the Trishul missile, a short-range surface-to-air weapon. Together these events show why the day is linked with self-reliance in technology. The day has been observed every year since the government began marking it in 1999. Preparation tip: when reading about nuclear and technology milestones, note the day, the number of tests in each series, and the codename used for each operation. Such details are easy to confuse, and they are often asked directly. Keeping a short table of dates and events makes revision faster.

Q1.

What was the codename of India's first nuclear test, conducted at Pokhran on 18 May 1974?

- (A) Operation Shakti
- (B) Operation Trident
- (C) Smiling Buddha
- (D) Operation Blue Star

Q2.

How many nuclear tests did India conduct on 11 May 1998 during Pokhran-II?

- (A) One
- (B) Two
- (C) Three
- (D) Five

Q3.

Assertion (A): India is recognised as a nuclear weapons state.

Reason (R): Pokhran-II nuclear tests were conducted in May 1998 under Operation Shakti.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Consider the following statements about India's nuclear tests:

- I. Pokhran-I was India's first nuclear test and was conducted on 18 May 1974.
- II. The 11 May 1998 series of tests was conducted under the codename Operation Shakti.
- III. Pokhran-I was conducted on 11 May 1974 as part of the Operation Shakti series.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Pokhran-II tests of May 1998:

- I. Three nuclear tests were conducted on 11 May 1998.
- II. Three nuclear tests were conducted on 13 May 1998.
- III. The tests were India's first confirmed nuclear detonations after 1974.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Who were the chief coordinators of the Pokhran-II tests?

- (A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee alone
- (B) Abdul Kalam and Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (C) Atal Bihari Vajpayee and R. Chidambaram
- (D) Abdul Kalam and R. Chidambaram

Q7.

In the order of nations that joined the nuclear club, which position did India reach through the Pokhran-II tests?

- (A) 4th
- (B) 5th
- (C) 6th
- (D) 7th

Constitution and labour laws: practice set

Labour welfare in India is shaped by two sources of authority: the Constitution and a body of ordinary statutes. The Constitution does not only grant rights to individuals; it also sets out aims that the State is expected to pursue. Some provisions protect workers from being made to work against their will, while others shield young people from early employment. Other provisions describe the kind of economic life the State should aim for, including a means of livelihood, employment within economic capacity, fair pay and a voice for workers in the industries where they work. Statutes have translated many of these aims into laws covering factories, wages, provident funds, compensation and disputes between employers and employees. Several of these statutes have since been grouped into a smaller number of broad codes. The codes group rules on wages, industrial relations, social security and occupational safety and health. Each statute addresses a specific aspect of work, such as the payment of wages, the settlement of disputes or compensation to workers. Labour matters also have an international dimension, since a United Nations agency works to improve labour conditions and living standards across the world. Together, these provisions and laws show that labour protection in India has both a constitutional foundation and a statutory one.

Q1.

Which Article of the Indian Constitution prohibits employment of children below the age of 14 years?

- (A) Article 24
- (B) Article 23
- (C) Article 39(a)
- (D) Article 43

Q2.

Which Article of the Indian Constitution orders the State to secure a living wage, decent conditions of work and social and cultural opportunities to all workers?

- (A) Article 39(a)
- (B) Article 41
- (C) Article 43A
- (D) Article 43

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 19(1)(c)	A. Equal right to an adequate means of livelihood
II. Article 39(a)	B. Right to work and education within economic capacity
III. Article 43A	C. Right to form associations or unions
IV. Article 41	D. Participation of workers in management of industries

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements about labour provisions in the Indian Constitution:

- I. Article 23 prohibits forced labour.
- II. Article 19(1)(c) prohibits employment of children below 14 years.
- III. Article 43A provides for participation of workers in management of industries through legislation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about labour laws in India:

- I. The Workmen's Compensation Act was enacted in 1923.
- II. The Payment of Wages Act was enacted in 1948.
- III. The Employees' Provident Fund Act was enacted in 1952.
- IV. The Industrial Disputes Act was enacted in 1947.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

According to the chart, which labour code amalgamates the largest number of laws?

- (A) Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code
- (B) Wage Code
- (C) Industrial Relations Code
- (D) Social Security Code

Q7.

In which year was the Contract Labour Act enacted?

- (A) 1923
- (B) 1936
- (C) 1952
- (D) 1970

ASEAN Basics and Forums

Southeast Asia is home to a regional grouping that has become central to how countries in the region manage their relations with one another and with major outside powers. Its members have long preferred a cautious style of diplomacy, in which governments avoid commenting on or interfering in each other's domestic affairs. Leaders and ministers meet through a network of regional forums that cover trade, politics and security, and several of these meetings now include partners from outside the region. The group has also tried to deepen economic ties, aiming to make trade, investment and the movement of people easier across national borders. Its record is not without difficulty. A dispute over a busy sea route has remained unresolved for years, and the group has been criticised for its limited response to a political crisis inside one of its member states. For India, the region has a special importance. New Delhi has built deep political, economic and security ties with the grouping over many years, and its own regional outreach policy places the grouping at the heart of its approach to the wider Indo-Pacific. The group's ability to act together will shape how much influence it can exercise in the years ahead.

Q1.

The ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) was established in which year?

- (A) 1992
- (B) 2005
- (C) 1994
- (D) 2015

Q2.

Where is the headquarters of ASEAN located?

- (A) Bangkok, Thailand
- (B) Singapore
- (C) Jakarta, Indonesia
- (D) Manila, Philippines

Q3.

In which year was the East Asia Summit (EAS) created?

- (A) 2005
- (B) 2002
- (C) 2015
- (D) 1967

Q4.

On which date did the ASEAN Charter take effect?

- (A) 8 August 1967
- (B) 15 August 1997
- (C) 1 January 2015
- (D) 15 December 2008

Q5.

Assertion (A): Decision-making in ASEAN is done through consultation and consensus.

Reason (R): The ASEAN Charter is legally binding and registered with the UN Secretariat.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ASEAN Regional Forum	A. Oversees implementation of ASEAN agreements and decisions
II. ASEAN Secretariat	B. Platform for dialogue on political and security issues
III. ASEAN Coordinating Council	C. Leaders-level forum with a varied agenda
IV. East Asia Summit	D. Supports and facilitates ASEAN's activities and initiatives

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

I. The ASEAN Charter took effect in 2008 and is legally binding.

II. The RCEP was concluded in 2019 and covers about 30 per cent of the world's population.

III. The ASEAN Free Trade Area was established in 1967.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The ASEAN Economic Community was formed in 2015 to facilitate the free flow of goods, services, investments, capital and labour.
- II. The East Asia Summit was created in 2002 as a leaders-level forum.
- III. The East Asia Summit is a leaders-level forum with a varied agenda.
- IV. The ASEAN Regional Forum was established in 1992.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Governance and Parliamentary Oversight

Governance in India is judged at several levels, and each level has tools to measure performance. At the village level, a national framework assesses how well local bodies deliver rural services. Rather than offering a simple ranking, it places each body into a category based on a composite score, so officials can see where improvement is needed. The framework is also linked to global development goals, which connects local priorities to wider targets for sustainable growth. Accurate measurement depends on good data. Government statistics agencies run regular surveys of economic activity, including enterprises that are not registered as companies. Such data is useful for planning because it captures sectors that formal records often miss. Finally, oversight of public money rests with Parliament. A committee drawn from both Houses examines how the government spends money and studies reports prepared by the country's audit institution. Its members are chosen in a way that reflects the balance of political parties, which gives the committee its credibility. This oversight protects financial discipline in public spending. Together, these mechanisms show how measurement, statistics and legislative scrutiny support accountability in public administration.

Q1.

A Gram Panchayat secures a composite score of 80 under the PAI 2.0 framework. Which grade does it receive?

- (A) Achiever (A+)
- (B) Aspirant (C)
- (C) Performer (B)
- (D) Front Runner (A)

Q2.

Which state had the highest share of Front Runners among the top performers in PAI 2.0?

- (A) Kerala
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Karnataka
- (D) Tripura

Q3.

How many members does the Public Accounts Committee have in total?

- (A) 22
- (B) 15
- (C) 7
- (D) 30

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Public Accounts Committee can examine government expenditure only after it has been incurred.

Reason (R): The recommendations of the Public Accounts Committee are binding on the government.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ASUSE 2025	A. Released by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj
II. Public Accounts Committee	B. Karnataka won the highest number of awards
III. Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0	C. Constituted in 1921 after the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms
IV. National Panchayat Awards 2025	D. Conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. PAI 2.0 grades Gram Panchayats on a composite score out of 100.
- II. The Front Runner (A) grade covers scores between 60 and 74.
- III. The ASUSE covers both rural and urban India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. PAI 2.0 translates 17 SDGs into 9 Localised SDGs.
- II. The National Panchayat Awards were launched in 2011.
- III. ASUSE moved from a calendar-year cycle to an October-September cycle in 2025.
- IV. The Public Accounts Committee was first constituted in 1947, after Independence.

How many of the statements above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

By convention, from which group is the Chairperson of the Public Accounts Committee chosen?

- (A) Treasury benches of the ruling party
- (B) Rajya Sabha members only
- (C) Ministry of Finance nominees
- (D) Opposition party

Global Cooperation Check

India's external engagement now reaches small businesses abroad, labour rights at home and the working of central banks. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar inaugurated India-supported projects in Trinidad and Tobago under an initiative that supplies equipment to small and medium enterprises in countries of the Global South. The programme is an Indian developmental cooperation initiative, so its benefits flow to partner countries.

Labour standards also came into focus when tea plantation workers in West Bengal raised allegations of violations in tea estates. The allegations concern conditions inside the tea estates themselves. Their complaint was taken to an international body that holds member countries accountable for implementing ratified conventions. Tea itself is governed by a national board that regulates cultivation, production, sale and export.

On the financial side, the Reserve Bank of India and the European Central Bank have revised a memorandum of understanding, which means an earlier arrangement between them has now been updated. The aim is to enhance cooperation in banking supervision and financial regulation. The euro area is a group of European Union countries that use the euro as their official currency, and its central bank sits at the centre of this cooperation. Over the years, the euro area has expanded as more countries adopted the currency, and additions have come in different years.

Q1.

Which ministry implements the SEEDS initiative?

- (A) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- (B) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (C) Ministry of External Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Defence

Q2.

In which year did Bulgaria join the Eurozone as a recent addition?

- (A) 2026
- (B) 1998
- (C) 2023
- (D) 1960

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Tea Board	A. Implemented by the Ministry of External Affairs
II. European Central Bank	B. Created under the Tea Act 1953
III. Eurozone	C. Headquartered in Frankfurt
IV. SEEDS	D. 21 member countries

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Industrial associations of workers or employers' organisations can file a complaint against a member country under Article 24.
- II. Croatia and Bulgaria joined the Eurozone in the same year.
- III. The Eurozone was established under the Maastricht Treaty.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The SEEDS initiative supports small and medium enterprises in Global South countries.
- II. The RBI and the ECB have signed a revised MoU on banking supervision.
- III. The Tea Board was established by a 1960 Act.
- IV. The Eurozone has 27 member countries.

- (A) Only three
- (B) None
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only two

Q6.

Tea plantation workers in West Bengal invoked Article 24 of the constitution of which international body?

- (A) European Central Bank
- (B) Reserve Bank of India
- (C) Tea Board
- (D) International Labour Organization

Q7.

In which year was the Eurozone established under the Maastricht Treaty?

- (A) 1960
- (B) 1992
- (C) 1998
- (D) 2023

UAE: Trade, Energy and Community Links

The United Arab Emirates is one of India's most important partners in energy, trade and defence. In FY 2025-26, bilateral trade between India and the UAE stood at US\$100 billion, and the UAE is a major supplier of crude oil, LNG and LPG to India. Recent talks have also covered crude storage at Fujairah under India's Overseas Strategic Reserve Framework. A Strategic Defence Partnership framework has been advanced, and a Ship Repair Cluster is planned at Vadinar through an MoU between Cochin Shipyard Limited and Drydocks World. The UAE's defence cooperation has three components, covering the military, the navy and the air force. Indian nationals form the largest expatriate community in the country. The Kafala system regulates the relationship between employers and migrant workers in several Gulf countries, and it has drawn attention to issues such as non-payment of wages. Artificial intelligence is another area of cooperation, with a term sheet signed for 8 Exaflop Super Computing Clusters. Investment cooperation includes plans by two funds to explore investments of up to US\$1 billion in India's infrastructure sector. Both sides have also discussed a long-term LPG sale agreement between ADNOC Gas Limited and IOCL. Relations also include joint cultural initiatives, such as an MoU supporting a maritime heritage complex at Lothal in Gujarat.

Q1.

What does the word 'Kafala' mean in Arabic?

- (A) Sponsorship
- (B) Migration
- (C) Partnership
- (D) Residence

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Barakah Nuclear Power Plant	A. UAE's first traditional Hindu stone temple
II. Order of Zayed	B. India's refuelling access at Al Dhafra
III. BAPS Hindu Temple (Abu Dhabi)	C. UAE's highest civilian award
IV. Al Dhafra Air Base	D. Arab World's first nuclear power plant

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UAE's capital is Abu Dhabi.
- II. The UAE has a maritime border with Qatar in the Persian Gulf.
- III. The UAE shares a land border with Iran.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Which two countries share land borders with the UAE?

- (A) Qatar and Iran
- (B) Oman and Qatar
- (C) Oman and Saudi Arabia
- (D) Saudi Arabia and Iran

Q5.

Three statements are given below. How many of them are correct?

- I. In 2022, India was the first country with which the UAE signed a CEPA.
- II. The UAE accounted for 18% of India's remittance flows.
- III. The UAE is a federal, elective monarchy of 5 emirates.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which currency is used in the UAE, according to the booklet?

- (A) Rial
- (B) Riyal
- (C) Dinar
- (D) Dirham

Italy and Netherlands: Partnerships and Heritage

Italy and India have built a broad relationship that now covers trade, technology, culture and heritage. Italy has also joined the International Solar Alliance and the Global Biofuel Alliance, and both countries have backed the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEEC). Italy is also part of the India-Italy-Japan trilateral, which focuses on Indo-Pacific security, stability and multilateral cooperation. Italy is an important trading partner for India within the European Union, and its Indian diaspora is the largest in the bloc. The Netherlands is another key partner, serving as a gateway to Europe for Indian business and ranking among the top sources of foreign direct investment. Cooperation with the Netherlands includes water management, climate resilience and sustainable infrastructure. Universities in the Netherlands have partnered with IIT Delhi and IISc for semiconductor research, talent development and advanced technology. Cultural diplomacy has also played a role, as ancient copper plates were returned to India by a Dutch university. Leiden University is among the institutions that returned heritage objects to India. Together, these exchanges show how India's partnerships in Europe combine economic, scientific and cultural goals.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Afsluitdijk Dam	A. Corridor linking Asia and Europe
II. Kalpasar Project	B. Dholera (Gujarat)
III. Tata Electronics-ASML MoU	C. Freshwater IJsselmeer Lake
IV. IMEEC	D. Gulf of Khambhat

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q2.

Which programme connects Indian students studying in Italy with internships, skill development and corporate employment?

- (A) Brain Bridge Initiative
- (B) Italy Calls India
- (C) Culture Bridge Programme
- (D) Study in Europe Mission

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The FAO was founded on 16 October 1945.
- II. The capital of the Netherlands is Amsterdam.
- III. The Afsluitdijk Dam is 42 km long.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

What did India and Italy upgrade their bilateral relations to?

- (A) Comprehensive Economic Partnership
- (B) Green Strategic Partnership
- (C) Special Strategic Partnership
- (D) Enhanced Defence Partnership

Q5.

In which city is the headquarters of the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) located?

- (A) Rome
- (B) Paris
- (C) Geneva
- (D) Vienna

Q6.

Assertion (A): India and Italy have declared 2027 as the Year of Culture and Tourism.

Reason (R): The declaration commemorates 80 years of diplomatic relations between the two countries.

Which of the following is correct?

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q7.

Three statements are given below. How many of them are correct?

- I. The Anaimangalam Copper Plates were commissioned by Rajaraja Chola I.
- II. The collection consists of 21 large and 3 smaller copper sheets.
- III. The inscriptions on the plates are written only in Sanskrit.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Habshan-Fujairah pipeline: MCQ practice

The United Arab Emirates operates a crude oil pipeline that runs across the country. It starts at inland oil fields and carries crude to the coast, giving the UAE an additional route for moving its oil to buyers. The booklet links the pipeline to greater flexibility in the UAE's exports. The UAE's exit from OPEC and OPEC+ has been described as a major geopolitical shift. Because the country is a large oil producer, its supply decisions now sit outside the group's collective framework. The booklet presents a table of suppliers' shares in India's crude imports, which shows how that supply is divided among several producers. India is one of the buyers discussed in the booklet, and the topic sets out how the UAE's exit could affect its energy planning. Taken together, the topic links a national pipeline, a change in the structure of an oil group, and the position of a large importing country. The pipeline and India's stake form a separate part of the booklet's coverage from the discussion of the exit itself. Both parts of the topic concern how oil moves from producers to buyers. The UAE is a major oil producer, and the booklet places its exit within a wider change in how producers coordinate.

Q1.

Amid disruption risks, what does the pipeline enable the UAE to do?

- (A) Reduce its oil reserves
- (B) Enable higher output
- (C) Settle energy deals in rupees
- (D) Join the IEA

Q2.

Which strait does the Habshan-Fujairah pipeline bypass?

- (A) Strait of Hormuz
- (B) Strait of Malacca
- (C) Strait of Gibraltar
- (D) Strait of Dover

Q3.

Examine the statements below:

- I. The Habshan-Fujairah pipeline is located in the UAE.
- II. The UAE's exit makes India's de-dollarisation impossible.
- III. India stands to gain from decreased oil prices.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Assertion (A): Heightened market volatility could complicate India's long-term energy budgeting.

Reason (R): India stands to gain when oil prices rise.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Origin of the pipeline's crude oil	A. Lower import costs and eased inflationary pressure
II. Effect of lower oil prices on India	B. Heightened market volatility complicating energy budgeting
III. Effect of the UAE's exit on negotiations	C. Inland oil fields of Habshan
IV. Risk to India's long-term energy planning	D. Direct bilateral negotiations outside traditional cartel restrictions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

India stands to gain from which change in oil prices?

- (A) A sharp increase
- (B) No change
- (C) A fixed rise
- (D) A decrease

NEET-UG 2026 cancellation: MCQ practice

NEET 2026 was declared compromised amid allegations of a paper leak. Authorities initiated an investigation after reports surfaced about illicit paper leaks and the circulation of unauthorised exam material. Evidence uncovered by law enforcement formed part of the investigation, and the decision reflects a commitment to fairness in high-stakes academic evaluations across the country. NEET is the national entrance examination for admission into medical colleges across India. Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students. Re-conducting compromised examinations imposes a heavy financial burden on government institutions. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was introduced to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. Investigations under the Act are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police. Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable. The scope of unfair means includes leakage of question papers or answer keys, candidate impersonation, unauthorised assistance during examinations, and tampering with computer systems or networks. The Central Government may transfer investigations to a Central Investigating Agency when required. Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for ethical students. Large-scale cheating causes parents and students to lose confidence in educational fairness.

Q1.

Which body voided the initial NEET-UG 2026 results?

- (A) Department of Higher Education
- (B) Ministry of Education
- (C) National Testing Agency
- (D) Department of School Education

Q2.

Which evidence was described as closely mirroring the actual NEET-UG 2026 test?

- (A) Official syllabus copies
- (B) Revised exam calendars
- (C) Candidate application forms
- (D) Fraudulent 'guess papers'

Q3.

What further application cost must candidates pay for the NEET-UG 2026 re-test?

- (A) A reduced fee
- (B) A full fresh fee
- (C) No further application cost
- (D) Only a late-registration fee

Q4.

Assertion (A): The NEET-UG 2026 re-test will be held for all candidates.

Reason (R): The NEET-UG 2026 examination was officially cancelled.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Initial NEET-UG 2026 results	A. Closely mirrored the actual test
II. Re-test application cost	B. Circulated on digital platforms
III. Fraudulent 'guess papers'	C. No further payment required
IV. Unauthorised exam material	D. Voided by the NTA

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. The NEET-UG 2026 examination was officially cancelled.

II. The initial results were retained after the investigation.

III. Candidates must pay a fresh application fee for the re-test.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

The NTA voided the initial results.

The re-test is for all candidates.

A fee is payable for the re-test.

The fraudulent guess papers were part of the evidence.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only one

NEET, NTA and the 2024 controversy: MCQ

NEET is the national entrance examination for admission into medical colleges across India, and it is conducted by the National Testing Agency. In 2024, an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks, which drew attention to the examination. After the controversy that followed, the Ministry of Education formed a high-level committee to examine the matter. NEET 2026 was later declared compromised amid allegations of a paper leak, and the examination was officially cancelled. Authorities initiated an investigation after reports surfaced about illicit paper leaks and the circulation of unauthorised exam material. Evidence uncovered by law enforcement formed part of the investigation. The initial results were voided to maintain integrity and public trust, and candidates will take the test again without paying any further application costs. The decision reflects a commitment to fairness in high-stakes academic evaluations across the country. Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students. Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for ethical students. Large-scale cheating causes parents and students to lose confidence in educational fairness. Re-conducting compromised examinations imposes a heavy financial burden on government institutions. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was introduced to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations.

Q1.

In which year was the National Testing Agency established?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2017
- (C) 2014
- (D) 2016

Q2.

Who headed the high-level committee constituted after the NEET-UG 2024 controversy?

- (A) Former RBI Governor Raghuram Rajan
- (B) Former CAG Vinod Rai
- (C) Former CJI D Y Chandrachud
- (D) Dr K Radhakrishnan

Q3.

Where is the headquarters of the National Testing Agency located?

- (A) Mumbai
- (B) Chennai
- (C) New Delhi
- (D) Bengaluru

Q4.

Assertion (A): The NTA is an autonomous body under the Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education.

Reason (R): The NTA conducts JEE Main and CUET.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Full-mark scorers in 2023	A. No candidate
II. Full-mark scorers in 2022	B. Pradeep Kumar Joshi
III. Head of the NTA	C. Former ISRO Chairman
IV. Dr K Radhakrishnan	D. Only two candidates

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The NTA was established in 2017.
- II. The NTA headquarters is located in Mumbai.
- III. The NTA conducts CUET.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

The NTA was established in 2014.

The NTA is an autonomous body under the Department of Higher Education.

The NTA conducts JEE Main.

Pradeep Kumar Joshi heads the NTA.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Ripple effect of exam malpractice: MCQ

NEET is the national entrance examination for admission into medical colleges across India. In 2024, an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks, which drew attention to the examination. After the controversy that followed, the Ministry of Education formed a high-level committee to examine the matter. NEET 2026 was declared compromised amid allegations of a paper leak. Authorities initiated an investigation after reports surfaced about illicit paper leaks and unauthorised exam material, and evidence uncovered by law enforcement formed part of the probe.

The NTA decided to void the initial results to maintain integrity and public trust, and the test will be administered again. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was introduced to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. The scope of unfair means under the Act includes leakage of question papers or answer keys, candidate impersonation, unauthorised assistance during examinations, tampering with computer systems or networks, conducting fake examinations, and manipulating official documents. Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable. Investigations are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police. The Central Government may transfer investigations to a Central Investigating Agency when required.

Q1.

How does the booklet group the impacts of exam malpractice?

- (A) Physical and legal damage
- (B) Systemic and institutional damage, and impact on students
- (C) Political and cultural damage
- (D) Economic and academic damage

Q2.

What does the loss of system credibility reduce, according to the booklet?

- (A) Admission quotas
- (B) Examination fees
- (C) Teacher recruitment
- (D) Market value of degrees and merit rankings

Q3.

What does re-conducting compromised examinations impose on government institutions?

- (A) Lower administrative costs
- (B) No additional expense
- (C) A heavy financial burden
- (D) Greater public trust

Q4.

Assertion (A): Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students.

Reason (R): Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for honest candidates.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Loss of system credibility	A. Delay admissions
II. Large-scale cheating	B. Heavy financial burden on government institutions
III. Re-conducting compromised examinations	C. Reduces market value of degrees
IV. Exam cancellations	D. Parents and students lose confidence

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Loss of system credibility reduces the market value of degrees and merit rankings.
- II. Re-conducting compromised examinations reduces the financial burden on government institutions.
- III. Exam cancellations can disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

Large-scale cheating causes parents and students to lose confidence in educational fairness.

Unfair practices bring significant stress to honest candidates.

Re-conducting compromised examinations reduces spending by government institutions.

The impacts are grouped only as damage to the system.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Competing Claims over the Site

The Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Complex is a medieval monument protected by the Archaeological Survey of India. Its identity has been contested for a long time, and the building is described differently in tradition, in later historical records and in modern legal proceedings. Accounts of the complex therefore draw on several strands of evidence that do not always agree.

According to tradition, the structure was built by a king whose name is still attached to the building. The term Bhojshala, however, did not come into use until a later date. It became linked to the building in the early twentieth century, when inscriptions found at the site drew attention to that name.

Later records describe a period of Muslim rule during which the building was reportedly adapted for use as a mosque. Excavations in the twentieth century also brought to light an intricately carved image, and its later history has become part of the wider debate over the site. Both communities have made claims about the building, and these claims have shaped the matter before the courts.

The case before the Madhya Pradesh High Court concerned the right to worship at the site. The court was asked to decide questions about worship rather than ownership.

Q1.

Who is traditionally credited with building the complex, and in which year?

- (A) Mehmudshah Khilji in 1514 AD
- (B) Nagabhata I in 730 AD
- (C) Raja Bhoj in 1034 AD
- (D) Kamaluddin Chishti in 1200 AD

Q2.

The carved image found at the site during excavations is currently housed where?

- (A) National Museum, New Delhi
- (B) Madhya Pradesh State Museum, Bhopal
- (C) Louvre Museum, Paris
- (D) British Museum, London

Q3.

In which year was the building reportedly converted into a mosque?

- (A) 1526 AD
- (B) 1192 AD
- (C) 1600 AD
- (D) 1514 AD

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The complex is a medieval monument located in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh.
- II. The carved image found at the site is housed in the National Museum, New Delhi.
- III. The site was traditionally regarded as a centre of Sanskrit learning and scholarship.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Inscriptions that linked the name Bhojshala to the building	A. Hazrat Maulana Kamaluddin Chishti
II. Original dedication of the building	B. KK Lele
III. Ruler under whom the building was reportedly converted	C. Goddess Saraswati (Vagdevi)
IV. Sufi saint associated with the Kamal Maula Mosque	D. Mehmudshah Khilji

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Hindus claim the site as a Saraswati temple.
- II. Muslims identify the structure as the Kamal Maula Mosque.
- III. The building was converted into a mosque in 1192 AD under Muhammad Ghori.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Architecture and Inscriptions

The Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Complex preserves structural remains and carved inscriptions that help historians study the site. The remains include a hall whose plan is typical of a particular kind of Hindu temple architecture. The inscriptions are among the most informative features of the complex, and several of them are cut into stone.

Some inscriptions are carved on pillars in a chart-like arrangement that appears designed to teach learners. Others are cut into stone slabs on the walls, where verses honour an avatar of a major Hindu deity. Other inscriptions name several rulers, which connects the site to the wider dynastic history of the region.

The inscriptions also refer to a Sanskrit drama named Karpuramanjari, which links the site to literary history. The Madhya Pradesh High Court later considered the site's history in a legal case, and the High Court has declared the site a Hindu temple. The Places of Worship Act, 1991 was also examined, since the court considered whether it applied to the complex at all.

The Archaeological Survey of India holds full supervisory, management and administrative control over the property. Its role covers regulating religious access and preserving the monument. The complex is a medieval monument that remains under the protection of the Archaeological Survey of India.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Founder of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire	A. Kannauj (Mahodaya)
II. Capital of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire	B. Ashadhara
III. Most illustrious emperor of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire	C. Nagabhata I
IV. Jain scholar linked to the royal tutor Madana	D. Raja Bhoj (Mihir Bhoja)

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q2.

In which language are the two odes to Kurma Avatara composed?

- (A) Sanskrit
- (B) Pali
- (C) Hindi
- (D) Prakrit

Q3.

Which author wrote the Sanskrit drama Karpuramanjari, which is referenced at the site?

- (A) Madana
- (B) Kalidasa
- (C) Bhavabhuti
- (D) Vishakhadatta

Q4.

Remains at the site indicate a hall of which architectural style, characteristic of Hindu temples?

- (A) Shikhara-style
- (B) Mandapa-style
- (C) Gopuram-style
- (D) Vimana-style

Q5.

Assertion (A): The pillar inscriptions at the site teach Sanskrit grammar to learners.

Reason (R): The Sarpabandha inscriptions chart the Sanskrit alphabet, noun and verb terminations, and the ten tenses and moods of Sanskrit grammar.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Paramara rulers Udayaditya and Naravarman are mentioned in the inscriptions.
- II. The Sarpabandha inscriptions chart the ten tenses and moods of Sanskrit grammar.
- III. Nagabhata I founded the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire in 1514 AD.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) All of the above
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only three

CJI Appointment and Collegium Rulings

The appointment of judges to the Supreme Court has been a subject of repeated litigation in India, and the Court has ruled on it several times. For a long period after the Court was set up, the seniormost judge of the Supreme Court was generally appointed Chief Justice of India. This practice was set aside twice in the 1970s, when the government chose judges who were not the seniormost. The Constitution requires the President to consult certain persons before appointing judges, and the meaning of the word consultation became a dispute. The First Judges Case of 1981 examined this word. The Second Judges Case of 1993 later revisited the question of how the Chief Justice of India should be chosen. The Third Judges Case of 1998 dealt with the process that the Chief Justice must follow before sending recommendations to the Government. Parliament later sought to replace the collegium with a new body, the National Judicial Appointments Commission, through a constitutional amendment and an Act. The Fourth Judges Case of 2015 examined that amendment and the Act. The rulings are known as the First, Second, Third and Fourth Judges Cases. The 1973 and 1977 appointments were made by the government of the time.

Q1.

In the Third Judges Case (1998), how many judges giving an adverse opinion would stop the CJI from sending a recommendation to the Government?

- (A) One judge
- (B) Two judges
- (C) Three judges
- (D) Four judges

Q2.

In which year were the 99th Constitutional Amendment Act and the National Judicial Appointments Commission Act enacted?

- (A) 2011
- (B) 2014
- (C) 2015
- (D) 1993

Q3.

Which judgment held that the advice tendered by the Chief Justice of India is binding on the President in matters of appointment of judges?

- (A) First Judges Case (1981)
- (B) Third Judges Case (1998)
- (C) Fourth Judges Case (2015)
- (D) Second Judges Case (1993)

Q4.

Assertion (A): Under the Second Judges Case (1993), only the seniormost judge of the Supreme Court should be appointed Chief Justice of India.

Reason (R): The National Judicial Appointments Commission Act was upheld by the Supreme Court in 2015.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chairperson of the NJAC	A. Declared the NJAC and 99th Amendment void
II. Eminent persons to be nominated to the NJAC	B. Ex-officio member of the NJAC
III. Union Law Minister	C. Nominated by CJI, PM and Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha
IV. Fourth Judges Case (2015)	D. Chief Justice of India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The First Judges Case (1981) held that consultation only implies exchange of views.
- II. The Third Judges Case (1998) held that the sole opinion of the Chief Justice of India constitutes consultation.
- III. The Fourth Judges Case (2015) declared the 99th Constitutional Amendment Act and the NJAC Act void.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The First Judges Case (1981) held that consultation means concurrence.
- II. One of the two eminent persons to be nominated to the NJAC must be from SC/ST/OBC/Minorities or Women.
- III. If one judge gives an adverse opinion, the CJI must not send a recommendation to the Government.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Jurisdiction and Temporary Benches

The Supreme Court of India exercises more than one kind of jurisdiction. It hears appeals against decisions of lower courts, decides certain disputes at the first instance, and gives advice when asked. A person whose Fundamental Rights have been violated may approach the Court directly, which gives the Court a role beyond routine appeals. The President of India can also refer questions of public importance to the Court. The Constitution provides for situations in which the Court may need a temporary head or additional judges. One provision deals with the office of the Chief Justice of India when that office is vacant or cannot be filled, while others allow the Chief Justice to draw on judges who are not part of the regular bench. Such provisions are meant for specific circumstances and carry their own conditions. Some of these arrangements involve a retired judge or a High Court judge. The Court's jurisdiction is therefore divided into several parts, each set out in the Constitution. The arrangements described above allow the Court to continue its work when its regular composition is incomplete or its head is unavailable. Each of these provisions is a separate route, and a reader must know which one applies to a given situation.

Q1.

Under which Article can a person approach the Supreme Court directly for the violation of Fundamental Rights?

- (A) Article 131
- (B) Article 32
- (C) Article 134A
- (D) Article 143

Q2.

The advisory opinion that the Supreme Court gives when the President seeks it under Article 143 is what for the President?

- (A) Binding on Parliament
- (B) Binding on the President
- (C) Not binding on the President
- (D) Binding only in criminal matters

Q3.

Under Article 126, from which category is an Acting Chief Justice of India appointed?

- (A) Judge of the Supreme Court
- (B) Retired Chief Justice of India
- (C) Chief Justice of a High Court
- (D) Attorney General of India

Q4.

Assertion (A): The President of India can seek the opinion of the Supreme Court under Article 143 on a question of public importance.

Reason (R): The opinion of the Supreme Court given under this power is not binding on the President.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 126	A. Retired judge sitting temporarily
II. Article 127	B. Disputes between Government of India and States
III. Article 128	C. Acting Chief Justice of India
IV. Article 131	D. Ad hoc judge for lack of quorum

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Article 134A requires a High Court certificate for an appeal that involves a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution.
- II. Under Article 128, a retired judge may sit only with the previous consent of the President and of the person to be appointed.
- III. Under Article 127, the CJI can appoint an ad hoc judge without the previous consent of the President.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Article 131 gives the Supreme Court original jurisdiction in disputes between the Government of India and one or more States.
- II. The CJI can appoint an Acting Chief Justice of India under Article 126.
- III. Article 32 allows a direct approach to the Supreme Court for violation of Fundamental Rights.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

Origin and Objective: MCQ practice

Changing parties after being elected has long been a concern in Indian politics. An old expression, often quoted in this context, describes members who switched their political loyalties again and

again, and it is linked to a period of frequent shifts among legislators. The rules that address this problem form part of the Constitution. They sit in a dedicated schedule, which groups the provisions on the subject together. These rules were brought in through a constitutional amendment, so they were added to the Constitution rather than passed as an ordinary statute. Two officers play a central role when a complaint is raised under them: the Speaker of the Lok Sabha and the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. Their decisions matter because they determine whether a member keeps a seat. The booklet also records that these decisions have been the subject of concern for some time. The subject has also been examined in several Supreme Court judgments, which the booklet lists in its discussion of the topic. Those judgments deal with the powers of presiding officers and the extent to which courts may review their decisions. Taken together, the origin of the rules, their place in the Constitution, and the officers who apply them form the basic background for understanding how the framework works in practice.

Q1.

Read the following statements:

- I. The phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' is linked to party-switching in the 1960s.
- II. The law was introduced through the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003.
- III. The law applies to both Parliament and State Legislatures.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

What does the Anti-Defection Law lay down?

- (A) The process by which legislators may be disqualified on grounds of defection
- (B) The procedure for electing the Speaker
- (C) The number of members needed to form a government
- (D) The salaries payable to presiding officers

Q3.

Based on the booklet, how many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The law was introduced through the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1985.
 - II. The law applies to both Parliament and State Legislatures.
 - III. The phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' is linked to party-switching in the 1970s.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q4.

To which legislatures does the Anti-Defection Law apply?

- (A) Only the Lok Sabha
- (B) Only State Assemblies
- (C) Both Parliament and State Legislatures
- (D) Only the Rajya Sabha

Q5.

The phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' is linked to frequent party-switching by legislators in which decade?

- (A) 1940s
- (B) 1960s
- (C) 1980s
- (D) 2000s

Q6.

Through which Constitutional Amendment Act was the Anti-Defection Law introduced?

- (A) 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976
- (B) 61st Constitutional Amendment Act, 1988
- (C) 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003
- (D) 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1985

Grounds for Disqualification: MCQ practice

The rules on loss of membership are set out as a list of specific grounds, and the list covers both a member's conduct and his or her personal circumstances. Some grounds relate to choices a member makes in connection with a political party. Others relate to the member's status and to certain personal circumstances. Decisions on these grounds are made by the presiding officer of the house. A ground must be clearly made out before a seat can be lost, and the rules do not treat every political disagreement as a reason to remove a member. Membership of a legislature therefore depends on whether one of the listed grounds applies, and the booklet describes the grounds in some detail for this reason. When a listed ground is found to apply, the member can lose the seat. The booklet sets out these grounds one after another, so that each can be checked separately against the facts of a particular case. Each ground is a distinct condition, and a member is judged against the specific ground that has been alleged.

Q1.

Under any law made by which authority can a legislator be disqualified?

- (A) Parliament
- (B) The Supreme Court
- (C) The President
- (D) The Election Commission

Q2.

Which of these is a ground for disqualification?

- (A) Speaking during Question Hour
- (B) Chairing a debate
- (C) Introducing a private bill
- (D) Holding an office of profit

Q3.

Read the following statements:

- I. Voluntarily giving up party membership is a ground for disqualification.
- II. Abstaining from a vote contrary to the party whip is not a ground.
- III. Disqualification under any law made by Parliament is a ground.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Based on the booklet, how many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Holding an office of profit is a ground for disqualification.
- II. Being declared of unsound mind by a court is a ground for disqualification.
- III. Criticising the party leadership in public is a ground for disqualification.

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Which of the following is a ground on which a legislator can be disqualified?

- (A) Criticising government policy in the House
- (B) Being declared of unsound mind by a court
- (C) Moving a private member's bill
- (D) Missing committee meetings

Q6.

Which of these is a ground relating to a legislator's loyalty to the state?

- (A) Attending an international conference
- (B) Speaking about foreign policy
- (C) Showing allegiance to another country
- (D) Sponsoring a trade bill

Significance and Key Issues: MCQ practice

Laws that govern elected members often attract debate, and the rules discussed here are part of that debate. The booklet looks at the purposes these rules serve and at the concerns that have been raised about how they work in practice. Presiding officers hold a central place in the framework, since they receive complaints and take the decisions that the rules require. Courts also form part of the picture, because their power to examine those decisions shapes how a matter is finally settled. Political parties are involved as well, since they issue instructions to their members in the legislature. The booklet treats several themes separately, and each one is presented with its supporting points. The rules are part of the Constitution itself. Taken together, these themes describe a framework that has clear strengths and also raises concerns on specific points. The discussion moves from the background of the rules to the way they work and then to the points on which they have been criticised. The framework is set out in a structured way, with its purpose, its working and its criticisms presented in turn. Each of these parts can be read on its own, and together they give a balanced account of the subject.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Delay in decision-making	A. Speaker or Chairman may act partisanly
II. Allegations of bias	B. Whips issued on non-critical matters
III. Limited judicial intervention	C. Petitions pending for long durations
IV. Rigid whip system	D. Courts intervene only after the Speaker's decision

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q2.

Based on the booklet, how many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The law ensures party stability and prevents government instability.
 - II. The law makes legislators unaccountable for their conduct.
 - III. The law reinforces democracy and combats corruption.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) All of the above
 - (D) Only two

Q3.

The law aims to prevent defections motivated by which of these?

- (A) Office or material gain
- (B) Ideological debate in the House
- (C) Disagreement over budget allocations
- (D) Changes in a party's symbol

Q4.

Read the following statements:

- I. The law allows party mergers without disqualifying members.
- II. Courts typically intervene before the Speaker decides a petition.
- III. The rigid whip system is criticised for reducing intra-party democracy.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Assertion (A): The rigid whip system is criticised for limiting intra-party democracy.

Reason (R): Party whips are issued even on matters that are not critical.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q6.

Which key issue is linked to the two-thirds merger clause?

- (A) Rigid whip system on non-critical matters
- (B) Large-scale defections enabled by the merger clause
- (C) Delay in deciding petitions
- (D) Partisan conduct of the Speaker

Q7.

Which of these is listed as a significance of the Anti-Defection Law?

- (A) Abolishing the office of the Speaker
- (B) Making legislators accountable for their conduct
- (C) Allowing parties to be formed without members
- (D) Ending the whip system altogether

Why Austerity Is Sought (MCQ)

India's foreign exchange reserves have fallen sharply within a short period. The booklet describes a drop of nearly USD 38 billion over two months, taking the reserves to around USD 691 billion by May 2026. The decline has been linked to volatile oil prices, record-breaking gold imports and the central bank's market intervention to defend the rupee. In response to growing concerns over the reserves, the Prime Minister has urged citizens to reduce non-essential spending on gold purchases, overseas travel and fuel. The government's concern is that the current account deficit has widened at a time when the currency is under pressure. Household gold imports, in particular, do not add to productive capacity. Rising fertiliser prices have added another layer to the problem, forcing a choice between fuel use and food security, and the government has given food security the higher priority. The booklet says the strategy must balance the immediate need for financial security against the long-term health of the nation's industrial sectors. The booklet presents these steps as part of a wider effort aimed at the economy's future needs. The measures are meant to provide currency stability and manage inflation. The booklet frames these concerns as central to

the government's current approach.

Q1.

According to the booklet, how much does each USD 1 increase in the price of oil add to India's import bill?

- (A) USD 1.5 to 2 billion
- (B) USD 0.5 to 1 billion
- (C) USD 3 to 4 billion
- (D) USD 10 billion

Q2.

Which feature of import demand does the booklet cite as a reason for a persistent current account deficit?

- (A) Elastic import demand
- (B) Falling import prices
- (C) Inelastic import demand
- (D) Surplus export demand

Q3.

What does the booklet identify as the implication of declining forex reserves?

- (A) Lower sensitivity to global capital flows
- (B) Reduced buffer against external shocks
- (C) A surplus in the balance of payments
- (D) Higher gold reserves held by the RBI

Q4.

Assertion (A): Cutting non-essential imports helps India conserve foreign exchange.

Reason (R): Foreign exchange reserves are external assets maintained by the Reserve Bank of India.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the goals behind the shift to demand-side restraint:

- I. Lowering energy-to-GDP sensitivity is one of the stated goals.
- II. Increasing dependence on volatile regions is one of the stated goals.
- III. Strengthening resilience against global shocks is one of the stated goals.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements on the import bill and the rupee are correct?

- I. Energy imports form one part of India's twin import burden.
- II. Non-essential imports are excluded from India's twin import burden.
- III. A weaker rupee raises the cost of imports.
- IV. Sharp increases in imports can lead to a reduction in forex reserves.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Costs of Excessive Forex Conservation (MCQ)

The booklet argues that the drive to conserve foreign exchange carries costs for the wider economy. It cautions that overly strict controls could stifle manufacturing and broader economic growth. The text also looks back at history, and earlier efforts to reduce dependence on foreign goods are presented as a warning. Household spending is another concern, as the booklet examines how curbs on it would affect the wider economy. Industry is also in view. The booklet notes that a balance must be struck between the immediate need for financial security and the long-term health of industrial sectors. In this account, policymakers must weigh the value of stable reserves against the risks to manufacturing and growth. Measures taken to protect the currency therefore have to be judged against their effects on the wider economy. The booklet lists several channels through which these effects could spread, including manufacturing, household spending and the broader growth of the economy. The booklet also places this discussion within the current concerns about the rupee and the reserves, which have been under pressure in recent months. The text also states that imports become more expensive when the rupee weakens. This linkage is part of the wider picture the booklet paints for the economy.

Q1.

According to the booklet, what is the effect of restricting imports on the economy?

- (A) Higher industrial output and exports
- (B) Lower industrial output and exports
- (C) Lower interest rates for businesses
- (D) Higher foreign direct investment

Q2.

Assertion (A): Reducing private consumption strengthens economic growth.

Reason (R): Private consumption is a major component of GDP.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

What does the booklet say Indian industry depends on imports for?

- (A) Imported capital goods, semiconductors and raw materials
- (B) Domestically mined coal and cement
- (C) Finished consumer electronics alone
- (D) Agricultural produce such as wheat and rice

Q4.

How do foreign investors respond to economies lacking strong domestic demand and high growth potential?

- (A) They increase their stake sharply
- (B) They avoid such economies
- (C) They shift only to government bonds
- (D) They ignore demand conditions

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the costs of strict import curbs:

- I. Foreign direct and portfolio investment inflows could be dampened.
- II. Restricted imports raise industrial output.
- III. Suppressing consumption mirrors past strategies that led to slower-than-expected economic development.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the costs of forex conservation are correct?

- I. Suppressing private consumption threatens aggregate demand.
- II. Excessive forex conservation has no effect on investment inflows.
- III. Past import-substitution attempts led to high industrial competitiveness.
- IV. Capital control concerns lower the country risk premium.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only one
- (D) All of the above

How the Press Freedom Index Works

Press freedom refers to the ability of journalists to gather information and publish it without undue pressure. Conditions for this differ widely from one country to another, and the World Press Freedom Index compares them within a single framework. The index ranks countries and regions according to the level of freedom available to journalists. To reach this ranking, it evaluates several aspects of the media environment, including how varied the media are, how independent they remain, and how well the legal system supports them. A central tool in this work is a questionnaire that gathers information on the conditions in which reporters operate. The results are released in a published report that places each country on a list and allows readers to compare nations with one another. Because the report reflects conditions at the time of assessment, a country's position can change when its situation changes. A free press is also described as one that acts independently, promotes transparency and holds powerful people accountable. Journalism therefore has a role beyond the newsroom, since it can give a voice to those who lack institutional power and can highlight injustices that would otherwise go unseen. For this reason, the index serves as a measure of how well journalists are able to do their work.

Q1.

Which organisation publishes the World Press Freedom Index?

- (A) UNESCO
- (B) Reporters Without Borders
- (C) Committee to Protect Journalists
- (D) Freedom House

Q2.

On what scale is each country scored in the index?

- (A) 0 (worst) to 10 (best)
- (B) 1 to 5, with 5 being worst
- (C) 0 (worst) to 100 (best)
- (D) -100 to +100

Q3.

What is the stated aim of the World Press Freedom Index?

- (A) Safeguarding the right to freedom of information
- (B) Setting trade rules for media companies
- (C) Funding journalism education in universities
- (D) Measuring advertising revenue of newspapers

Q4.

Assertion (A): The index ranks countries and regions according to the level of freedom available to journalists.

Reason (R): The index is published by the Press Council of India.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Press Freedom Questionnaire	A. Paris, France
II. Aim of the index	B. Non-profit organisation
III. Publisher's legal type	C. Safeguarding the right to freedom of information
IV. Publisher's headquarters	D. Covers five categories

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the design of the index:

- I. The index evaluates the safety of journalists among its criteria.
- II. A higher score on the index indicates less freedom for the press.
- III. The organisation behind the index has its headquarters in Paris.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- (i) The Press Freedom Questionnaire covers five categories.
- (ii) The index has been published as an annual report since 1985.
- (iii) Each country's score runs from 0 (worst) to 100 (best).

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Press Freedom: Challenges and Role

Press freedom is shaped by a number of pressures, and financial strain is among the most widely noted. Media outlets in many countries face financial instability, which can threaten independent and unbiased reporting. Freedom of expression is regarded as vital to preserve journalistic integrity and to prevent undue influence from state or private actors. A free press is described as one that acts independently, promotes transparency and holds powerful people accountable. Its work reaches beyond the newsroom, since it highlights systemic injustices and enables public participation in democratic discourse through information, critique and civic dialogue. News coverage can also influence discussions in parliamentary and legislative bodies. A widely quoted line makes a similar point in a few words: where the press is free, and every man able to read, all is safe. These roles explain why the press is treated as significant in public life. Taken together, the pressures on the press and the roles it plays help explain why its condition matters to a society as a whole. Independence, transparency and accountability are therefore the qualities by which such a press is described. Freedom of the press is linked to a range of functions, from informing the public to examining those in power.

Q1.

The press is often called the fourth pillar of democracy. Alongside which three organs is it counted?

- (A) Legislature, judiciary and executive
- (B) Army, police and bureaucracy
- (C) Election commission, universities and unions
- (D) Industry, banks and markets

Q2.

During the pandemic, the media acted as which of the following?

- (A) A source of advertising revenue for governments
- (B) A replacement for public health services
- (C) A critical communication tool between government and citizens
- (D) A tool for political campaigning

Q3.

Whose remark on a free press and literacy is quoted in the booklet?

- (A) Mahatma Gandhi
- (B) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (C) Winston Churchill
- (D) Thomas Jefferson

Q4.

Assertion (A): Freedom of the press in India is treated as part of freedom of speech and expression under the Constitution.

Reason (R): Article 19(2) of the Constitution lists reasonable restrictions on freedom of speech and expression.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 19(2)	A. Gives visibility to those without institutional power
II. Romesh Thappar vs State of Madras (1950)	B. Reasonable restrictions on the right
III. Press as voice of the voiceless	C. Precursor to legislative and social reform
IV. Press sparks public debate	D. Freedom of press lies at the foundation of democratic organisations

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the press in India:

- I. Freedom of media is an absolute freedom under the Constitution.
- II. Community journalism is described as promoting social cohesion and local accountability.
- III. Political instability is linked to a decline in media freedom.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- (i) The press serves as a bridge between the governed and the governing.
 - (ii) Article 19(2) states that freedom of the press is absolute.
 - (iii) During the pandemic, media reduced panic and fought misinformation.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

LEADS 2025 State and UT Categories

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, has released the 7th LEADS 2025 Report. LEADS is India's national index for benchmarking logistics performance across the States and Union Territories of India. It evaluates each State and UT across key logistics parameters, including infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment, operational efficiency and data-driven logistics reforms.

The 2025 edition introduced a four-tier classification system in place of the earlier model. It places States and UTs in four new categories: Exemplars, High Performers, Accelerators and Growth-Seekers. Each entry also carries a regional tag, and the tags used in the report are Coastal, Landlocked, North-East (N-E) and UTs. The regional tag appears next to each name in these lists.

The report includes a section titled State Performance in LEADS 2025 that lists the States and UTs under each category. Some States and UTs have moved between categories compared with earlier years, so the placement in one edition may differ from the previous one. The four categories and four regional tags together describe each entry in the report.

The same occasion saw the Department confer the LEAPS Awards 2025 to recognise excellence and innovation in India's logistics sector.

Q1.

Which State was categorised as an Achiever from 2022 to 2024 before achieving Exemplar status in LEADS 2025?

- (A) Uttar Pradesh
- (B) Haryana
- (C) Punjab
- (D) Rajasthan

Q2.

Which Union Territory improved from Fast Mover in 2024 to High Performer in 2025?

- (A) Delhi
- (B) Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu
- (C) Jammu and Kashmir
- (D) Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Q3.

Under which category is Sikkim (N-E) placed in LEADS 2025?

- (A) Accelerators
- (B) Exemplars
- (C) High Performers
- (D) Growth-Seekers

Q4.

Read the assertion and the reason.

Assertion (A): Andhra Pradesh is placed in the Growth-Seekers category in LEADS 2025.

Reason (R): Andhra Pradesh is tagged as a Coastal entry in the report.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Accelerators	A. Delhi
II. Growth-Seekers	B. Tripura
III. High Performers	C. Punjab
IV. Exemplars	D. Sikkim

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Examine the statements below:

- I. The 2025 edition introduced a category named Growth-Seekers.
- II. Jammu and Kashmir is placed in the Accelerators category in LEADS 2025.
- III. The report uses a regional tag called UTs.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. Uttar Pradesh was an Achiever from 2022 to 2024 before becoming an Exemplar.
- II. Tripura is placed in the High Performers category with the North-East tag.
- III. Andaman and Nicobar Islands is placed in the Accelerators category.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Logistics Initiatives and the LPI

The LEADS 2025 Report was released by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. It appears alongside a set of national programmes meant to strengthen India's logistics sector. Among these is the PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021, which appears in the report's list of initiatives. The report describes LEADS as India's national index for benchmarking logistics performance across the States and Union Territories.

Other programmes listed in the report include the Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme, Bharatmala Pariyojana, the Sagarmala Programme and the E-Way Bill System. Each is named as part of the wider effort. The report also notes that logistics costs in India remain relatively high. The 2025 edition also introduced a four-tier classification system.

The LEADS framework evaluates States and UTs across key logistics parameters, including infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment, operational efficiency and data-driven logistics reforms. The report also refers to the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index. India's position in that index is reported for 2023. The Logistics Performance Index is a World Bank index. The Department also conferred the LEAPS Awards 2025 to recognise excellence and innovation in India's logistics sector.

This topic appears in the May 2026 current affairs compilation under the heading Summits, Reports, Indices.

Q1.

Which programme aims to improve road connectivity across India?

- (A) Sagarmala Programme
- (B) Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme
- (C) Bharatmala Pariyojana
- (D) E-Way Bill System

Q2.

Which programme aims to enhance freight speed, reduce costs and improve tracking?

- (A) Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme
- (B) Sagarmala Programme
- (C) PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021
- (D) E-Way Bill System

Q3.

The Logistics Performance Index analyses differences between countries in which of the following respects?

- (A) Tax rates on freight and fuel prices
- (B) Railway passenger fares and tourism flows
- (C) Airline ticket prices and cargo volumes
- (D) Customs procedures, logistics costs and infrastructure for overland and maritime transport

Q4.

Read the assertion and the reason.

Assertion (A): The National Logistics Policy 2022 aims to bring logistics costs in line with those of other developed countries.

Reason (R): The World Bank reports the Logistics Performance Index every 2 years.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021	A. Port-led development
II. Bharatmala Pariyojana	B. Digital bills for goods
III. Sagarmala Programme	C. Integrated planning across roads, railways, ports and airports
IV. E-Way Bill System	D. Road connectivity across India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Examine the statements below:

- I. The Logistics Performance Index includes customs performance among its key dimensions.
- II. The National Logistics Policy 2022 aims to raise logistics costs.
- III. The Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme aims to enhance freight speed.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. The E-Way Bill System is one of the programmes named in the report.
 - II. The Logistic Efficiency Enhancement Programme aims to reduce freight speed.
 - III. Logistics costs in India are around 8.5% of GDP.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Origin of the day: MCQ practice

National Technology Day is observed in India on 11 May each year. It is a day set aside to commemorate major technological achievements, and it recalls a series of milestones the country reached on one particular date. Those milestones spanned different areas of work. One was related to nuclear research, one to aviation, and one to defence development carried out by a national research organisation. The day was given formal recognition by a senior national leader, and it has been observed every year since the first full year of observance. The name of the day has remained the same since it was first observed. Because it falls on a fixed date, the day gives the public a regular occasion to look back at how science and engineering have contributed to the country. The observance does not celebrate a single invention. Instead, it groups several achievements together under one date and one name. The milestones belonged to the same period of work, which is why they are remembered together. Each year the day keeps these achievements in the national calendar, linking past progress with present interest in technology. Its origins therefore lie in a specific set of events rather than in a general idea of progress alone.

Q1.

What was the theme of National Technology Day 2026?

- (A) Digital India: A New Tomorrow
- (B) Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth
- (C) Technology for All
- (D) Science for Sustainable Development

Q2.

Which agency test-fired the Trishul short-range surface-to-air missile on the day the observance commemorates?

- (A) ISRO
- (B) BARC
- (C) NITI Aayog
- (D) DRDO

Q3.

In which year were the technological achievements commemorated by the day recorded?

- (A) 1974
- (B) 1991
- (C) 1998
- (D) 2000

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar awards are announced on National Technology Day.
Reason (R): The Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar is India's science honour, comparable to the Padma Awards.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Atal Bihari Vajpayee	A. Series of nuclear tests in Rajasthan's Thar Desert
II. Pokhran-II	B. Short-range surface-to-air missile
III. Hansa-3	C. Declared the day as National Technology Day
IV. Trishul	D. Aircraft that completed its first successful test flight

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Hansa-3 completed its first successful test flight on the day commemorated.
- II. The day was declared in 2000 by a prime minister.
- III. The day has been observed annually from 1999 onward.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Pokhran-II tests were conducted in the Thar Desert of Rajasthan.
- II. Trishul is a long-range ballistic missile.
- III. The Hansa-3 test flight took place on the day commemorated.

- (A) Only three
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only two

Digital, farm and dairy milestones: MCQ practice

National Technology Day also draws attention to India's progress in digital infrastructure, farm output and dairy. These achievements are not limited to laboratories. They affect how citizens pay for goods, how farmers grow food and how milk reaches households. The observance groups these areas together with the country's scientific and engineering work. International assessments also compare countries on innovation, patents and intellectual property, and these comparisons are published by global bodies. Such assessments are referred to in discussions about the country's

technological standing. The observance therefore links everyday technology with national standing. Each year, the day offers a chance to look at these developments together, including the systems that run across the country and the changes in food and dairy production. These achievements show how technology has entered ordinary life. They form a second strand of the observance, alongside the milestones that the day recalls from its origin. The areas are varied, which is why the day is treated as a broad recognition of technological progress rather than of one sector alone. Their scope is one reason the observance is wider than a single anniversary of one event. Taken as a whole, the observance covers machines, laboratories, farms and dairies alike.

Q1.

Which organisation's report is cited for India's intellectual property filings?

- (A) UNESCO
- (B) NITI Aayog
- (C) WIPO
- (D) World Bank

Q2.

Which index is cited for India's 2026 innovation standing?

- (A) Human Development Index
- (B) Happiness Index
- (C) Corruption Perceptions Index
- (D) Global Innovation Index

Q3.

Which system is described as the world's largest biometric ID system?

- (A) UPI
- (B) Aadhaar
- (C) NM-ICPS
- (D) iDEX

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Green Revolution boosted India's grain production.

Reason (R): High-yielding wheat and rice varieties were used in the Green Revolution.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Aadhaar	A. Revolutionised digital payments
II. UPI	B. World's largest biometric ID system
III. Green Revolution	C. Made India the world's largest milk producer
IV. White Revolution	D. High-yielding wheat and rice varieties

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The White Revolution made India the world's largest milk producer.
- II. UPI was launched as a biometric identity system.
- III. The WIPO report is cited for India's intellectual property filings.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Aadhaar is the world's smallest biometric ID system.
- II. The Green Revolution used high-yielding wheat and rice varieties.
- III. The 2026 observance theme was 'Responsible Innovation for Inclusive Growth'.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Institutions and schemes: MCQ practice

India runs a number of public bodies, missions and schemes that are meant to support technology. These institutions differ in their purpose. Some work on research and development, some support new companies, and some focus on the link between government needs and private innovation. A few programmes are designed for students, so that young people can take part in experiments and build practical skills early in their education. Others target specialised sectors where the country wants to develop its own capabilities. Some bodies were created by a specific Act, while others operate as programmes under national agencies. Some are led by national bodies, while others operate through government departments. Together these arrangements form a support system that links science, industry and education. Each institution has its own role within this system. Some schemes are linked to national missions with defined focus areas. The variety of these arrangements is one reason the day is observed as a broad recognition of technological work. This variety is visible in the range of programmes that the country runs at once, in several sectors. Each of them can be understood by its purpose, its sector and the group it serves.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. iDEX	A. Support for startups
II. NM-ICPS	B. Private sector participation in the space programme
III. IN-SPACe and NSIL	C. R&D in AI, Robotics, IoT and Quantum Computing
IV. Atal Incubation Centres	D. Indigenous defence startups and MSMEs

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q2.

Which mission, launched by NITI Aayog, aims to foster an innovation culture?

- (A) Atal Innovation Mission
- (B) Make in India
- (C) National Supercomputing Mission
- (D) INSPIRE

Q3.

In which year was the Act that makes the Technology Development Board a statutory body passed?

- (A) 1974
- (B) 1995
- (C) 2000
- (D) 2014

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The National Supercomputing Mission plans to install a network of world-class supercomputers across premier institutions.
 - II. INSPIRE is a programme linked to DST that encourages science education and research careers.
 - III. iDEX supports defence startups only in the nuclear sector.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Technology Development Board promotes the commercialisation of indigenous technology.
- II. Make in India was launched in 2014 to boost domestic manufacturing.
- III. The National Quantum Mission focuses only on quantum computing.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

What are Atal Tinkering Labs?

- (A) Startup incubators
- (B) Innovation labs in schools
- (C) Defence research centres
- (D) Quantum computing centres

Q7.

Assertion (A): The Technology Development Board provides financial assistance to commercialise indigenous technologies.

Reason (R): The Technology Development Board supports the adaptation of imported technology for wider application.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Origin of International Labour Day: MCQ practice

International Labour Day is observed each year in May to honour the contribution of workers across the world. Its origin is traced to the labour movement of the late nineteenth century in the United States, a period when workers were pressing for shorter working hours. In 1886, a large demonstration took place in America, and the gathering was an important moment for the movement. The events that followed in one city are known by their own name and are regarded as the point at which the day began. Several years later, socialist political organisations in another continent came together to choose a common date for the celebration. The observance then reached India in the early twentieth century, when the first May Day was celebrated in an Indian city by a political group. Today the day is recognised as a tribute to labour, and the booklet links its present theme to safety and health at work in a changing climate.

Q1.

According to the 1886 demonstration in America, workers demanded how many hours of work on a daily basis?

- (A) 6 hours
- (B) 10 hours
- (C) 8 hours
- (D) 12 hours

Q2.

In 1923, the first May Day in India was celebrated in which city?

- (A) Chennai (then Madras)
- (B) Mumbai (then Bombay)
- (C) Kolkata (then Calcutta)
- (D) Delhi

Q3.

In 1889, Socialist Parties in which region decided to celebrate May 1 as International Labour Day?

- (A) Asia
- (B) Europe
- (C) Africa
- (D) South America

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Haymarket Affair	A. Socialist Parties' decision to celebrate May 1 (1889)
II. Labour Kisan Party of Hindustan	B. Also known as Workers Day
III. 1889 decision on the date	C. Incident that marked the start of the day
IV. Workers Day	D. First May Day in India (1923)

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the origin of International Labour Day:

- I. The first May Day in India was celebrated in 1923.
- II. The Haymarket Affair took place in 1889.
- III. Socialist Parties in Europe decided on May 1 in 1889.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about International Labour Day:

- I. It is observed each year on May 1.
- II. The 1886 demonstration demanded a ten-hour working day.
- III. It is also known as Workers Day.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

ILO objectives, standards and reports: MCQ practice

The International Labour Organisation is a specialised agency of the United Nations, dedicated to improving labour conditions and living standards throughout the world. It promotes social justice and internationally recognised human and labour rights, and it is an integral part of the United Nations Human Rights Framework. The organisation sets out stated objectives that cover fundamental labour rights, greater opportunities for women and men, social protection, and social dialogue. Its international labour standards are legal instruments drawn up by its constituents, namely governments, employers and workers, and they set out basic principles and rights at work. Such standards come in more than one form, and each form carries a different status. Finally, the organisation publishes key reports that examine employment, wages and social protection across the world, and these reports help track conditions in the world of work.

Q1.

Which of the following is a focus area of the ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work?

- (A) Universal basic income
- (B) Free trade zones
- (C) Elimination of employment discrimination
- (D) Privatisation of public services

Q2.

Which of the ILO's international labour standards are described as non-binding guidelines?

- (A) Recommendations
- (B) Conventions
- (C) Protocols
- (D) Treaties

Q3.

What does the ILO's tripartite structure give to governments, employers and workers?

- (A) A veto power
- (B) Only advisory roles
- (C) Rotating presidency
- (D) An equal voice

Q4.

Assertion (A): Recommendations of the ILO cannot be enforced as legal obligations.

Reason (R): Recommendations are non-binding guidelines.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Forced Labour Convention	A. No. 111
II. Equal Remuneration Convention	B. No. 182
III. Discrimination Convention	C. No. 100
IV. Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention	D. No. 29

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the ILO:

- I. The ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work was amended in 2022.
- II. Recommendations are legally binding on member states.
- III. Freedom of association is among the focus areas of the ILO Declaration.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about ILO standards and objectives:

- I. Conventions and Protocols are legally binding international treaties.
- II. Recommendations are legally binding treaties.
- III. The ILO pursues four stated objectives.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

India's Partnerships: Vietnam, NZ and SAARC

India and Vietnam have raised their bilateral ties to an enhanced Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, a formal upgrade that followed a state visit by a Vietnamese leader. The two countries

have also agreed on a trade goal and plan deeper defence cooperation, including joint development of advanced defence platforms, which is set out in a Joint Vision Statement. Vietnam has formally joined an Indo-Pacific initiative that India supports, and the relationship is linked to India's wider engagement with Southeast Asia.

India has also signed a free trade agreement with New Zealand. A free trade agreement is a pact between countries to reduce or eliminate customs duties and liberalise trade in services, and it also ensures investment protection and safeguards for intellectual property rights. Sensitive sectors such as dairy and agriculture are kept outside the deal to protect domestic producers, and the two countries have agreed to mutually recognise organic certification standards.

In South Asia, the SAARC currency swap framework is a bilateral arrangement between central banks. Members exchange domestic currencies at a predetermined rate and reverse the exchange at a future date. The framework provides short-term liquidity support to member nations, helps them during balance of payments crises, reduces dependence on external borrowing and strengthens regional financial stability.

Q1.

In which year did the RBI launch the SAARC currency swap framework?

- (A) 2008
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2019

Q2.

What amount of defence line of credit has India extended to Vietnam?

- (A) USD 100 million
- (B) USD 250 million
- (C) USD 500 million
- (D) USD 1 billion

Q3.

What bilateral trade target have India and Vietnam set for 2030?

- (A) USD 5 billion
- (B) USD 10 billion
- (C) USD 50 billion
- (D) USD 25 billion

Q4.

Assertion (A): Indian exports to New Zealand face zero duty under the India-New Zealand FTA.

Reason (R): India gives New Zealand access to 100% of its tariff lines.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Sahyog	A. Pact to reduce dependence on critical mineral supply chains
II. VINBAX	B. Coast Guard exercise
III. My Son Sanctuary	C. Army exercise
IV. Strategic Rare Earths Pact	D. ASI restoration of a site linked to the Champa civilisation

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Vietnam has formally joined the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative.
- II. New Zealand has committed to invest USD 20 billion over 15 years.
- III. The SAARC currency swap tenure can be extended up to five times.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The SAARC currency swap tenure is three months.
- II. The Joint Vision Statement seeks reduced defence cooperation between India and Vietnam.
- III. My Son Sanctuary is associated with the ancient Champa civilisation.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Thucydides Trap, Ebola and Ecocide

The Thucydides Trap is a phrase used in international relations to describe the danger of conflict when a rising power challenges a power that is already dominant. The idea comes from the writings of Thucydides, who analysed a long war between two rival powers. Its core idea is that fear and rivalry between powers can make a clash more likely, and the concept is often discussed in relation to a rising power and an existing global power. Critics argue that the idea oversimplifies politics by suggesting conflict is unavoidable, while others stress that diplomacy and economic links can prevent escalation.

The World Health Organization has declared an Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo to be a serious international health emergency. Under the International Health Regulations, such a declaration applies when a health risk could spread across borders and needs a coordinated response. Ebola is a severe viral disease that can affect humans and primates.

Ecocide refers to unlawful or reckless acts that cause severe, widespread or long-term environmental damage, carried out with knowledge that such damage is likely. The idea has gained

legal attention, and several countries have written it into their own laws, which is one reason it is discussed in environmental debates.

Q1.

Which war did Thucydides analyse when developing the concept?

- (A) Trojan War
- (B) Punic War
- (C) Peloponnesian War
- (D) Crimean War

Q2.

Which strain of Ebola is linked to the WHO-declared outbreak in the DR Congo?

- (A) Zaire
- (B) Bundibugyo
- (C) Sudan
- (D) Reston

Q3.

In which region of DR Congo is the Bundibugyo-linked outbreak located?

- (A) Ituri
- (B) Kivu
- (C) Katanga
- (D) Kasai

Q4.

Assertion (A): Ebola is classified as a zoonotic disease.

Reason (R): Ebola was first identified in 1976.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Athens	A. Dominant established power in the Thucydides account
II. Sparta	B. DR Congo site of a 1976 Ebola outbreak near the Ebola River
III. Yambuku	C. South Sudan site of a 1976 Ebola outbreak
IV. Nzara	D. Emerging power in the Thucydides account

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Thucydides argued that the growth of Athenian power and the fear it caused in Sparta made conflict increasingly inevitable.
- II. Ebola belongs to the Filoviridae family.
- III. Ecocide is recognised as a crime under the Rome Statute.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Rome Statute recognises four international crimes.
- II. India has signed the Rome Statute.
- III. Vietnam was the first country to codify ecocide.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

SCO and IORA: Practice MCQs

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian grouping that brings together a number of states from the region. Its core objective is regional cooperation to counter terrorism, separatism and extremism. Its membership grew over time, and India joined in 2017, which strengthened India's engagement with Central Asia, a region where geographical constraints limit direct access. Taken together, the grouping's members account for a large share of the world's economic output and population.

Within the grouping, a regional body coordinates counter-terrorism work and intelligence sharing among members. Its emphasis on security is sometimes seen as overshadowing its economic and development cooperation. Border disputes and political frictions between some members are among the factors that affect constructive engagement.

The Indian Ocean Rim Association is a different kind of body. It is an intergovernmental organisation that promotes cooperation among countries bordering the Indian Ocean. Its areas of cooperation include maritime safety, fisheries management, trade facilitation and disaster risk management. Its vision was shaped during a visit to India by a prominent leader. The association also supports a track-based forum, the Indian Ocean Dialogue, which brings together policymakers, strategic experts and maritime stakeholders. The forum was first launched in Australia, and India has hosted several of its editions.

Q1.

Which country joined the Shanghai Five after its 1996 formation, turning the grouping into the SCO in 2001?

- (A) Kazakhstan
- (B) Uzbekistan
- (C) Kyrgyzstan
- (D) Tajikistan

Q2.

Where is the SCO's Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) based?

- (A) Beijing
- (B) Bishkek
- (C) Astana
- (D) Tashkent

Q3.

In which year was the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) established?

- (A) 1995
- (B) 2001
- (C) 1997
- (D) 2013

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Council of Heads of States is the SCO's supreme decision-making body.

Reason (R): The SCO's official languages are Russian and Chinese.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure	A. Beijing
II. IORA Secretariat	B. Perth
III. SCO Secretariat	C. Tashkent
IV. Indian Ocean Dialogue launch	D. Ebene

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The SCO's secretariat is located in Ebene, Mauritius.
- II. The IORA's secretariat is located in Ebene, Mauritius.
- III. The Indian Ocean Dialogue was first launched in 2013.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- (a) The SCO has observers including Mongolia.
 - (b) The IORA was established in 1995.
 - (c) The SCO's secretariat is located in Beijing.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Korea, Komagata Maru and Sikkim: Practice MCQs

The Korean peninsula was divided after the Second World War, and the division has shaped its politics ever since. A dividing line still marks the border between the two states, and a demilitarised zone lies along it. North Korea came under Soviet influence and South Korea under American influence, which deepened the divide. A war then broke out when troops from the north crossed that line, prompting the UN Security Council to condemn the invasion.

The history of Sikkim also shows how political arrangements can change a region's status. Earlier, British-era treaties had already tied the territory to British India. A Himalayan kingdom ruled by a hereditary royal dynasty came under Indian protection through an agreement, with India taking charge of defence, external affairs and communications. Later, the territory's status changed further, and after a popular vote it became a full state of India. Its identity and land rights are protected by a constitutional provision.

Another episode involves a ship that carried passengers from India towards Canada. The passengers were mostly Sikhs, with some Muslims and Hindus, and they hoped for economic opportunities within the British Empire. Canadian rules required travel directly from the country of origin, and only a small number of passengers were allowed ashore. Local community groups raised funds to challenge the discriminatory laws in court. The ship was eventually sent back to India, where passengers faced a confrontation with British authorities.

Q1.

Which 1950 agreement made Sikkim an Indian protectorate?

- (A) Treaty of Tumlong
- (B) Treaty of Titaliya
- (C) Calcutta Convention
- (D) Indo-Sikkim Treaty

Q2.

What did the Korean Armistice Agreement of 1953 lead to?

- (A) A permanent peace treaty
- (B) A ceasefire without a peace treaty
- (C) Immediate reunification of the two Koreas
- (D) A UN trusteeship over Korea

Q3.

Who led South Korea in the years after 1948?

- (A) Kim Il Sung
- (B) Douglas MacArthur
- (C) Syngman Rhee
- (D) Gurdit Singh

Q4.

Assertion (A): Sikkim was given Associate State status before it became a full state of India.

Reason (R): The 35th Constitutional Amendment created Associate State status for Sikkim in 1974.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Continuous Journey Regulation	A. 1975
II. Korean Armistice Agreement	B. 1950
III. Sikkim becomes the 22nd state of India	C. 1953
IV. North Korean invasion across the 38th Parallel	D. 1908

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

I. The Korean War ended with a formal peace treaty in 1953.

II. Sikkim became the 22nd state of India on 16 May 1975.

III. The Komagata Maru carried 376 Indian passengers to Canada in 1914.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

(a) Japanese occupation of Korea ended in 1945.

(b) India chaired the Neutral Nations Repatriation Commission.

(c) The Indo-Sikkim Treaty of 1950 gave Sikkim Associate State status.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

CDS, Peacekeeping and Awards: Practice MCQs

India's Chief of Defence Staff is a four-star officer who is equivalent in rank to the three service chiefs but functions as a first among equals. The post links the armed forces with civilian political leadership, and the officer advises the defence minister on tri-service military matters. The CDS also serves as Secretary of the Department of Military Affairs in the Ministry of Defence.

The United Nations uses peacekeeping missions, which combine military, police and civilian personnel, to help countries move from conflict to peace. India is among the largest troop contributors to these missions. One such mission supervises the ceasefire between India and

Pakistan in Jammu and Kashmir. Action for Peacekeeping, a UN initiative, treats women's full participation as central to peacekeeping performance. In 2025, an Indian officer serving in Lebanon received a UN award for advancing gender equality in peacekeeping.

Recognition in literature and journalism also stands out in this record. A novel translated from Mandarin Chinese recently won a major international prize for translated fiction, the first Mandarin novel to do so. Earlier Booker Prize winners include several novelists from India. The Pulitzer Prize is considered the highest national honour in the United States for journalism, literature and musical composition.

Q1.

Assertion (A): The CDS can hold office up to the age of 65.

Reason (R): The CDS has a fixed tenure of five years.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Which committee appoints the Chief of Defence Staff?

- (A) Parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence
- (B) Appointments Committee of the Cabinet
- (C) Chiefs of Staff Committee
- (D) Defence Acquisition Council

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Kargil Review Committee	A. 29 May
II. Shekatkar Committee	B. 1948
III. UN Peacekeeping founded	C. 2016
IV. International Day of UN Peacekeepers	D. 1999

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q4.

In which year was the post of Chief of Defence Staff created?

- (A) 2019
- (B) 2016
- (C) 1999
- (D) 2020

Q5.

UN peacekeepers are often called what?

- (A) Green Helmets
- (B) Red Caps
- (C) White Shields
- (D) Blue Berets

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The CDS can hold office up to the age of 70.
- II. The CDS must be below 62 years of age at the time of appointment.
- III. The CDS is the Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- (a) The Pulitzer Prize is administered by Columbia University.
 - (b) The UN Military Gender Advocate Award was created in 2016.
 - (c) UN Peacekeeping was founded in 1945.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

Defence and Border Infrastructure: MCQ Practice

Defence was a major area of focus in this month's current affairs. The Kalam & Kavach 3.0 Defence Conference was described as a high-level platform for deliberations on India's defence transformation, military modernisation and future preparedness. The conference brings defence themes into one forum, and the booklet treats it as a significant event for the sector. Another entry under the defence heading is the TARA weapon system. The booklet describes TARA as a glide weapon system developed in India, and it reports a recent trial of the system as a step in the country's defence progress. Each entry is written in short points, so readers can follow the key terms and the main features quickly. The booklet also covers border infrastructure under the same heading. The Border Roads Organisation is named as the body for this work, and it is discussed together with Project Deepak. The entries are kept brief, and the booklet gives the main terms and details for each item in a few lines. Together, these entries give a snapshot of defence news from the month. They describe a conference, a weapon system and a border agency, and each is presented as a separate point. Each point stands on its own, so the entries can be read in any order.

Q1.

What position does the booklet give TARA among India's indigenous glide weapon systems?

- (A) Second
- (B) First
- (C) Fourth
- (D) Third

Q2.

In which year was the Border Roads Organisation established?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1961
- (C) 1986
- (D) 1960

Q3.

Which ministry organised the Kalam & Kavach 3.0 Defence Conference?

- (A) Ministry of Defence
- (B) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (C) Ministry of External Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Earth Sciences

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. TARA	A. Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation
II. Project Deepak	B. Premier agency for border infrastructure
III. Border Roads Organisation	C. Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation
IV. JAI	D. Western Himalayas

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

Assertion (A): The Border Roads Organisation works in high-altitude and strategically sensitive areas.

Reason (R): The Border Roads Organisation has its headquarters in New Delhi.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Kalam & Kavach 3.0 conference was the second edition of the event.
- II. The conference was held in New Delhi.
- III. TARA's modular range-extension kit can be attached to an existing unguided warhead.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Kalam & Kavach 3.0 conference was held in Mumbai.
- II. DRDO and the Indian Air Force conducted the maiden flight trial of TARA.
- III. Project Deepak was launched in 1980.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Governance, Crime Data and Remembrance: MCQ Practice

The May 2026 Ailet Corner section of the booklet covers governance, crime data and remembrance. Its governance item is a skilling programme for the creative sector, which aims to

build AI capabilities that are ready for industry. The programme aims to strengthen India's creative economy and digital content ecosystem, and its target areas include media and animation. The programme is described as a way to build digital skills for people working in creative industries. Crime data is the second item. The National Crime Records Bureau released its Crime in India 2024 report, which the booklet describes as the first edition to include offences registered under a newer criminal code. The booklet also gives a short profile of the bureau, covering its origins and its place in the government. The final item recognises a warrior named Veera Pasi, who came from the Pasi community of Uttar Pradesh. Veera Pasi is remembered as a Dalit freedom fighter who took part in the Revolt of 1857 against British colonial rule, and the booklet recalls this figure's role among regional resistance heroes. Each item is short, so the section can be read in any order. The booklet presents each item under its own heading, with a few lines of description.

Q1.

Which ministry launched the National AI Skilling Initiative for the Creative Sector?

- (A) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- (B) Ministry of Culture
- (C) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- (D) Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Q2.

In which year was the National Crime Records Bureau established?

- (A) 1976
- (B) 1980
- (C) 1991
- (D) 1986

Q3.

Under which ministry does the National Crime Records Bureau function?

- (A) Ministry of Defence
- (B) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (C) Ministry of Law and Justice
- (D) Ministry of External Affairs

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Crime Records Bureau	A. Includes BNS offences alongside IPC
II. Indian Institute of Creative Technologies	B. Central repository of crime and criminal data
III. Veera Pasi	C. Implementing agency of the AI skilling initiative
IV. Crime in India 2024	D. Commander under Rana Beni Madhav Baksh Singh

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Assertion (A): The National Crime Records Bureau functions under the Ministry of Defence.

Reason (R): The National Crime Records Bureau acts as India's central repository of crime and criminal data.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National AI Skilling Initiative for the Creative Sector is developed in partnership with Google and YouTube.
- II. The NCRB's recommendations are based on the Tandon Committee and the National Police Commission.
- III. The Crime in India 2024 report includes offences under the IPC only.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The target sectors of the initiative include gaming.
- II. A statue of Veera Pasi was unveiled in Raebareli.
- III. Veera Pasi was a warrior from Bihar.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Nordic and Sweden Ties

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's engagements in the Nordic region combined a visit to Norway with participation in a regional summit series. The Nordic countries form a group in Northern Europe, and India has held a series of summits with them. Relations with Norway moved to a higher level, with a focus on clean energy, climate resilience, the blue economy and green shipping. Norway also joined an Indo-Pacific initiative led by India.

Sweden was the other key partner in this round. The two countries moved their ties to a strategic partnership and adopted a joint action plan that covers the years ahead. They endorsed joint development of a technology and artificial intelligence corridor, and agreed to set up a platform for small enterprises and start-ups. Modi also received a Swedish order that is among the highest honours a head of government can receive.

Economic links also matter. Norway's sovereign wealth fund has invested in India, and a trade agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association has been signed. Together, these steps show how the Nordic engagement joins climate, technology, trade and diplomacy in one strategy. The agreements cover both existing commitments and plans for future cooperation, so the outcomes are best read as a set of linked steps rather than isolated events.

Q1.

In how many years was PM Modi's visit to Norway the first bilateral visit by an Indian PM? (answer in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the 3rd India-Nordic Summit held?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which partnership did India and Norway upgrade their ties to? (name the partnership)

Answer: _____

Q4.

About how much has the Norwegian Sovereign Wealth Fund (GPFG) invested in India? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did India and Sweden launch LeadIT at the UN Climate Action Summit?

Answer: _____

Q6.

For which period is the India-Sweden Joint Action Plan designed? (give the years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many countries form the core Nordic group, as listed in the booklet?

Answer: _____

Reasons and Impact: Short Answer Set

One reason given for the UAE's exit is that output limits set through the producer group kept it from using its growing production capacity in full. The country's outlook looks ahead to a time when global oil demand may peak and then decline gradually. Its present approach is to earn strong oil revenues in the near term while preparing for a longer-term shift to renewable energy. Those revenues are intended to help fund growth in artificial intelligence and data centres, supporting a more diversified economy. Friction within the producer group over production policy has been long-standing, and rivalry between the UAE and a regional neighbour over economic and political influence has intensified. Infrastructure also adds flexibility: an inland pipeline in the UAE carries crude from oil fields to a coastal terminal on the Gulf of Oman, which helps exporters when shipping routes face disruption risks. For India, which imports a large share of its crude, lower oil prices would reduce import costs and ease inflation pressure, while a move away from group restrictions could allow direct bilateral deals. The booklet also notes that rising volatility could complicate long-term energy budgeting. Taken together, these developments show how energy, security and economic strategy are tied together in the Gulf.

Q1.

By 2027, what daily production level (in million barrels per day) does the UAE aim to reach?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which port does the Habshan-Fujairah Pipeline connect the inland oil fields to?

Answer: _____

Q3.

With which regional oil producer does the UAE have long-standing tensions over OPEC production policy?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which currency would the UAE's exit encourage energy settlements for India, supporting its de-dollarisation strategy?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the OPEC+ alliance formed?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Roughly what percentage of the world's crude oil does OPEC+ pump (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which former OPEC member was suspended from the group in 1992?

Answer: _____

Public Examination Act check

The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was framed to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. It covers a broad range of unfair means. Leaking question papers or answer keys, impersonating a candidate, and giving unauthorised assistance during an examination are all covered. So are tampering with computer systems or networks, conducting fake examinations, and manipulating merit lists or official documents.

Punishments depend on the offence and on the person responsible. Individuals who are found guilty can face imprisonment as well as monetary penalties, and organised malpractice carries monetary penalties as well. Service providers who run examinations can be fined and barred from conducting examinations for a fixed period. Organised crimes are punished separately under the Act.

Offences under the Act are serious. Investigations are carried out by senior police officers, and the Central Government has the power to shift an investigation to a central agency where needed. Together, these provisions treat examination fraud as a serious crime rather than a minor lapse.

Q1.

What is the minimum imprisonment (in years) for an individual found guilty under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years can a service provider be debarred from conducting examinations (in years)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the maximum monetary penalty (in crore rupees) for an individual in a case involving organised malpractice?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the minimum imprisonment (in years) for organised crimes under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which two property-related measures can be applied to organised crimes under the Act (give both terms)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the maximum imprisonment (in years) for an individual found guilty under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the maximum fine (in crore rupees) for a service provider under the Act?

Answer: _____

Places of Worship Act: key details

The Places of Worship Act, 1991 was passed by a Congress government to protect the religious identity of places of worship. Its central aim is to keep the religious character of each place as it stood on Independence Day. The Act prohibits converting a place of worship from one religious denomination to another, whether between or within denominations. It terminates pending legal proceedings about religious character conversions that took place before the cut-off, while allowing new cases about changes made after it. Violating the Act attracts imprisonment and fines. The Act exempts ancient monuments protected under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, and it does not cover the Ayodhya dispute and related legal proceedings. Critics argue that the Act limits judicial review, weakening constitutional checks and balances. Others say that it violates the right to freedom of religion and treats communities differently, undermining equality. Critics also argue that the Independence Day cut-off ignores historical injustices and earlier encroachments. The Supreme Court, in its verdict on the Ayodhya dispute, said that the Act upholds secular values and prohibits retrogression. Its supporters say the Act ensures the preservation of religious sites and their character, instilling confidence in all communities. Together, these points explain why the Act remains a contested law.

Q1.

In which year is the religious character of places of worship frozen to its Independence Day status? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which section of the Places of Worship Act are penalties provided? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which section are legal proceedings on pre-1947 religious character conversions terminated? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Prime Minister led the Congress government that passed the Places of Worship Act? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which section of the Places of Worship Act is conversion of a place of worship prohibited? (section number)

Answer: _____

Appointment, Tenure and Removal Facts

Judges of the Supreme Court are appointed by the President, and the Constitution lays down the qualifications a person must have before appointment. A candidate must be a citizen of India and must meet one of several experience-based or distinguished-jurist criteria. Once in office, a judge does not serve a fixed term. Instead, the judge continues until reaching a set retirement age, and may also choose to leave earlier by writing to the President. The Constitution provides a formal route for removal, which is demanding. Removal is permitted only on the grounds of proven misbehaviour or incapacity. A special law governs the procedure, and the same process applies to judges of the Supreme Court and of the High Courts. Several judges have faced removal motions in Parliament, and in some cases the motion failed or the judge resigned before the process was complete. The question of who should decide appointments has been debated for decades, and Court rulings have repeatedly reshaped the process. Consultation between the Chief Justice and other senior judges sits at the heart of that debate. These disputes show how closely appointments and removals are linked to judicial independence.

Q1.

Until what age (in years) does a Supreme Court judge hold office?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Act that governs the removal procedure for Supreme Court and High Court judges enacted?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which judge was impeached in Rajya Sabha in 2011 but resigned before the Lok Sabha discussion? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the Supreme Court, in the Second Judges Case, hold that consultation means concurrence?

Answer: _____

Q5.

According to the Third Judges Case, how many seniormost judges make up the collegium that the CJI must consult? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many eminent persons from civil society are to be nominated to the NJAC? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who was appointed Chief Justice of India in 1977 by superseding HR Khanna? (name as in text)

Answer: _____

Deciding Authority and Review

Once a disqualification petition is filed against a legislator, the central question becomes who decides it. The Constitution gives this power to the presiding officer of the house to which the member belongs, rather than to a court or to the executive. Critics argue that this arrangement places a significant power in the hands of someone who is often a member of the ruling party, which raises concerns about partisanship. Courts can step in, but generally only after the presiding officer has issued a decision, so the timing of judicial intervention is a recurring concern. Petitions can remain pending for long periods, and that delay can shape the stability of a government long

before a final verdict is reached. Judges have said such decisions should be taken within a reasonable timeframe, although deadlines are not always met in practice. A decision may be reviewed by a court on specific grounds, such as when it violates a constitutional requirement, reflects bad faith, or is so unreasonable that no proper authority could have reached it. The procedure also has to respect basic fairness, which means the affected member must be heard. Such review is an important safeguard, yet it does not replace the initial role of the presiding officer in the process.

Q1.

Who decides disqualification petitions for members of the Lok Sabha? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who decides disqualification petitions for members of the Rajya Sabha? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What fraction of the members of a legislature party must agree for a merger to avoid disqualification? (in words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Within how many months should decisions on disqualification ideally be made, as per *Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)*? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q5.

After how many months of nomination does a nominated member become liable to disqualification for joining a party? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which 2019 case involving the Karnataka Speaker lists the grounds for reviewing a Speaker's decision? (first-named party's name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the first-named party in the 1992 judgment on Speaker's decisions under the Tenth Schedule? (name)

Answer: _____

Import Pressure Check

India's external payments depend heavily on what the country imports. Energy is among the largest of these imports, and India relies on foreign suppliers for most of its crude oil. When oil prices move sharply, the import bill changes with them, which affects the trade balance and the demand for dollars. Gold is another major import. Household purchases of gold do not create productive assets in the way that official reserves do, so heavy gold buying adds to the strain on the current account. Fertiliser is a third pressure point. Imported inputs such as urea and ammonia have risen sharply in price, and the government must decide how to respond. It can pass the higher costs on to consumers, which carries a risk of inflation, or it can absorb the costs itself. A weaker rupee adds to the problem, because it makes every imported good more expensive in rupee terms. Outflows also arise from personal spending abroad, such as foreign travel and overseas weddings. Each of these pressures feeds the others, and the economy has to weigh short-term relief against long-term health. Understanding which imports drive the outflow of foreign exchange is the first

step in judging how much pressure the economy faces. Policy choices in this area therefore matter a great deal for households and businesses.

Q1.

What share of its crude oil requirement does India import, according to the booklet? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country is the largest gold consumer globally, per the booklet? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What share of India's total imports does gold account for? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How did imported urea and ammonia prices change, according to the booklet? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which security does the government prioritise over discretionary fuel consumption when fertiliser prices surge? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

If the government absorbs cost increases instead of passing them on, which risk arises? (name the risk)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which scheme does the booklet record significant foreign exchange outflows? (name in full)

Answer: _____

History of the Indian Press

Printing reached India through European trading companies, and for a long time newspapers were produced by colonial interests and Indian reformers alike. Colonial governments were uneasy about printed criticism. At different times they introduced rules to control what could be published, and some of these rules fell hardest on publications written in Indian languages. Even so, Indian editors kept bringing out weeklies that promoted social reform and nationalist ideas. Reformers used the press to challenge customs and argue for change in society. Over time, the limits on the press became a question for the courts and the constitution. Debates about press freedom focused on how expression could be balanced with public order and the rights of others. Later, statutory and non-statutory bodies were set up to watch over journalism and protect editorial standards, while professional associations of editors took up the defence of journalists' rights. Studying this history explains why modern India treats press freedom as important yet not absolute, and why the state and the press continue to debate where the limits should lie. The sequence of laws and institutions shows a long pattern in which governments tried to restrict the press while journalists sought wider freedom.

Q1.

In which year was India's first newspaper, the Bengal Gazette, published? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who published the Bengal Gazette? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Act issued by Lord Wellesley in 1799 curbed the press? (name of Act)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which 1835 Act is described as the liberator of the Indian press? (name of Act)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Vernacular Press Act enacted to suppress Indian press freedom? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Press Council of India abolished during the Emergency? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Act was the Press Council of India established as a statutory quasi-judicial body in 1978? (name of Act with year)

Answer: _____

Freight corridor figures

Dedicated Freight Corridors are exclusive tracks built for freight trains, and they support double-stack and heavy-haul trains that offer high capacity and speed. The corridors fall under the Ministry of Railways, and their implementation is handled by a dedicated corporation. A key objective is to reduce logistics costs, in line with the National Logistics Policy. The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor begins at JNPT in Mumbai, and it has improved port access and lowered transit times. Corridors of this kind have also generated jobs and attracted investment, which supports economic growth. Indian Railways' revenue growth is also linked to these corridors over a multi-year period. Construction has not been free of difficulty, because delays in the final section of the Western corridor added to project costs. Within the wider national plan, the corridors are expected to raise the share of rail in freight movement. The corridors are part of a larger network that is being built across several regions of the country.

Q1.

Which organisation is the implementing agency for the Dedicated Freight Corridors? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year do the Dedicated Freight Corridors aim to raise rail's share of freight to 45% under the National Rail Plan? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the National Logistics Policy, logistics costs are to be brought below what percentage? (in per cent, number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Up to which financial year is the period cited for DFCs' contribution to Indian Railways' revenue growth? (format: 2022-23)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which place is at the other end of the North-South DFC from Vijayawada? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the length of the North-South DFC? (in km)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the length of the East Coast DFC between Kharagpur and Vijayawada? (in km)

Answer: _____

Space and defence firsts

India's space programme has grown steadily over the years and now covers lunar, Martian and solar missions, along with satellites and launch services. Each mission was designed to answer a scientific question or to prove a new capability. Some missions were firsts for the country, while a few were firsts for the world. The programme is also opening up to private participation through bodies created for that purpose, which marks a change in how space work is organised. Upcoming missions are planned for later years and will extend the country's reach further. Defence technology has developed on a parallel track. Warships, submarines and combat aircraft built in India show how indigenous design has been applied to strategic needs. Examinations often test these achievements through a single detail, such as a mission name, a ship's name or a year. A simple timeline that places each mission and each vessel in order makes these details easier to recall. Revision should focus on what each achievement was, who achieved it first, and when it happened. Learning each mission together with its first is a practical method for exam preparation. Students who connect each achievement with its date and its institution find recall far easier than those who memorise isolated lists.

Q1.

Which Indian mission, India's first lunar mission, discovered water on the Moon? (give the mission name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many satellites were launched in one launch in 2017, a world record? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of India's first indigenous aircraft carrier? (name of the ship)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which submarine, dated 1967, was India's first indigenous submarine? (name of the submarine)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which crewed spaceflight, planned for 2027, will be India's first? (name of the mission)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of India's first solar mission? (name of the mission)

Answer: _____

ILO: short answer set

Some international bodies are created to set common standards rather than to govern countries directly. The body discussed here is one of them, and its concern is the working life of people across the world. It was set up under the Treaty of Versailles and was later linked with the United Nations. Its central aim is to improve labour conditions and living standards throughout the world. Its structure gives an equal voice to three groups: governments, employers and workers. The organisation has four stated objectives. It seeks to promote fundamental labour rights, create greater opportunities for women and men, enhance social protection and strengthen social dialogue. Its legal instruments take two forms. Conventions and Protocols are legally binding treaties, while Recommendations are non-binding guidelines. Some of its standards form part of the wider United Nations human rights framework. The organisation also publishes reports on employment, wages, social protection and youth. Its Director General leads the organisation's work. The work covers workers in many countries, including India, which is one of its founding members. Taken together, these standards and reports show how an international body can influence labour conditions.

Q1.

In which year did the ILO become the first specialised agency associated with the United Nations? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

According to the booklet, who is the Director General of the ILO? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the headquarters of the ILO located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the ILO awarded the Nobel Prize for Peace? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ILO Convention number deals with Minimum Age? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which ILO Convention number deals with Freedom of Association? (number)

Answer: _____

RBI Surplus and Capital Framework

The Reserve Bank of India earns income from its operations, and every year it decides how much of that income to keep and how much to pass on to the central government. The rules for these decisions are set out in a framework known as the Economic Capital Framework, which tells the

bank how to provide for financial risks and how to transfer its surplus. A surplus is the net income left after total expenditure is deducted from total income. The bank earns this income from buying and selling bonds in the market, from the interest it receives on bonds it holds, and from returns on its foreign currency assets. To guard against unexpected losses, such as falls in the value of securities or the effects of changes in interest rates, the bank maintains a contingency buffer. The surplus is handed over to the government only after this buffer has reached its target level. The bank's board has recently approved a record transfer to the government, and the framework itself has been reviewed by expert committees over time. Analysts see these transfers as helping the government with its finances, reducing its borrowing needs and supporting its spending on infrastructure.

Q1.

In which year was the RBI's Economic Capital Framework introduced?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which person headed the committee that reviewed the 2015-16 Economic Capital Framework?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the RBI Board's Technical Committee, led by YH Malegam, make its recommendation on surplus transfers?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which section of the RBI Act, 1934 must the RBI's profits be sent to the Centre?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How often must the Economic Capital Framework be reviewed, in years?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Enterprise-Wide Risk Management Framework, of which the Contingency Risk Buffer forms the core, introduced?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The RBI's surplus transfer to the government typically averages around what percentage of GDP (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Methane, Solar Wind and Space Missions

Monitoring the atmosphere and the space around Earth has become a major scientific priority. Methane is a gas that traps heat far more strongly than carbon dioxide over short periods, so detecting its leaks quickly matters for climate action. A satellite-based system has been designed to spot large leaks, the kind that release huge amounts of gas in a short time, and to help operators reduce them. The system was unveiled at a major international climate conference and has since been widened to cover new sources of emissions. Countries have also agreed on global targets for cutting methane, with a deadline later in the decade measured against an earlier baseline year. Turning from the air to the space around Earth, the Sun constantly releases a stream of charged particles that flows past our planet. Earth's magnetic field deflects much of this flow, and the region where the two interact shapes how well the planet is shielded from harmful radiation. A new mission from a European space agency and a partner from East Asia studies this interaction. It

captures images in two kinds of light at the same time and tracks how the solar flow meets the magnetic shield in near real time. Scientists hope these observations will show how the upper atmosphere responds when the Sun is active, and how the magnetic shield changes under pressure from the solar wind.

Q1.

Which satellite-based system, launched in 2022, detects major methane leaks? Give its acronym.

Answer: _____

Q2.

By how much, in per cent, does the Global Methane Pledge aim to cut global methane emissions by 2030 compared with 2020 levels?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Chinese institution co-launched the SMILE mission with the European Space Agency?

Answer: _____

Q4.

From which French overseas territory was the SMILE spacecraft launched?

Answer: _____

Q5.

SMILE stands for Solar Wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere ____ Explorer. Fill in the blank.

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along with China and India, which country is named among the world's largest methane emitters?

Answer: _____

Environment and Weather Check

Human-elephant conflict is a serious concern for communities living near elephant habitats, and it affects both people and the animals. The central government runs a national programme that protects elephants, conserves their habitats and maintains the corridors they use to move. A state has now decided to create a dedicated research centre on this conflict. Other measures focus on people and their livelihoods. Public awareness drives, community sensitisation and conservation education are meant to reduce retaliatory violence. One method uses bees to reduce elephant-human attacks, and it is run by a national body that supports village industries. A separate public campaign encourages coexistence between humans and elephants. Weather and air also need careful observation in cities. Under Mission Mausam, an urban testbed and aerosol observatory has been inaugurated in a city. Its work is linked with a Chennai-based research institute. The facility observes urban weather in real time, tracks air quality and aerosols, and supports climate-related research. The facility works in an urban setting, where weather and air observation are tracked in one system.

Q1.

Which tiger reserve will host India's dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre? (name of reserve)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Project Elephant launched by the Government of India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which campaign promotes coexistence between humans and elephants? (name of campaign)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which institute in Chennai is associated with India's Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ministry inaugurated India's Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory under Mission Mausam? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which state is set to establish India's dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Italy and Netherlands: Quick Facts

Italy and India have raised their relationship to a higher level, with cooperation across trade, defence, science and culture. Both countries back a corridor-linked initiative that seeks to improve trade connectivity, logistics, energy and digital links between Asia and Europe. Italy has also joined the International Solar Alliance and the Global Biofuel Alliance. Its programme for Indian students links them with internships, skill development and corporate employment. Italy is an important trading partner for India within the European Union. The Netherlands is a gateway to Europe for India and a significant source of investment. Cooperation with the Netherlands covers semiconductors, water management, climate resilience and sustainable infrastructure. Dutch universities have partnered with Indian institutions for semiconductor research and talent development. Heritage links are also part of the relationship, since a Dutch university returned ancient copper plates to India. Cooperation in water management also draws on Dutch experience with a large dam that turned a saltwater inlet into a freshwater lake, and India has its own proposal for a large freshwater storage project. The Netherlands also ranks among India's top sources of foreign direct investment, and Italy is also part of the India-Italy-Japan trilateral, which focuses on Indo-Pacific security and stability.

Q1.

What partnership level did India and Italy upgrade their bilateral relations to? (name the partnership)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What bilateral trade value, in EUR billion, did India and Italy commit to reach by 2029? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which year has been declared the Year of Culture and Tourism between India and Italy? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many years of diplomatic relations does the 2027 Year of Culture and Tourism commemorate? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), a UN specialised agency, founded? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which company signed an MoU with Tata Electronics to support India's semiconductor plant in Dholera, Gujarat? (name the company)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which Indian state is the proposed Kalpasar Project located? (name the state)

Answer: _____

UAE exit from OPEC: TITA practice

The United Arab Emirates has announced that it will leave OPEC and the wider OPEC+ grouping. OPEC is a group of oil-producing states that coordinates how much crude its members supply to the world. Much like a financial institution, the organisation adjusts output in response to global conditions. Its aim is to keep supply steady, so that prices remain sustainable for both consumers and the countries that produce oil. Its members depend heavily on the petroleum income that their economies earn, so stability matters to them. The OPEC+ grouping extends this cooperation by bringing OPEC together with major producers from outside the organisation. Taken together, the arrangement covers a large share of the world's crude oil. The UAE is one of the larger producers in the group, and its decision has been described as a major geopolitical shift. The departure could weaken OPEC's influence over the global oil market. The move has drawn wide attention across the energy sector, and it raises questions about how remaining members will plan their supply. The UAE joined the group in 1967, so its membership spanned several decades. The exit takes effect from 01 May 2026. The booklet presents the exit as a development in the international energy market that is still unfolding.

Q1.

What does OPEC primarily use to prevent extreme fluctuations in the cost of crude oil? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country is described as a key member of the OPEC+ alliance? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

The UAE's strategic energy shift prepares it for a long-term energy transition to what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Independent production strategies may lead to greater what in oil prices? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

OPEC's mandate is to protect whose interests by coordinating production policies? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In the short term, the UAE aims to maximise which kind of income from oil? (two words)

Answer: _____

NEET-UG 2026 cancellation: typed answers

NEET 2026 was declared compromised amid allegations of a paper leak. Authorities initiated an investigation after reports surfaced about illicit paper leaks and the circulation of unauthorised exam material. Evidence uncovered by law enforcement formed part of the investigation. The decision reflects a commitment to fairness in high-stakes academic evaluations across the country. The Ministry of Education formed a high-level committee after the NEET-UG 2024 controversy, when an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks. NEET is the national entrance examination for admission into medical colleges across India. Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students. Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for ethical students. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 aims to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable. Investigations under the Act are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police. The Central Government may transfer investigations to a Central Investigating Agency when required. Loss of system credibility reduces the market value of degrees and merit rankings. Conducting fake examinations and manipulating official documents are also listed as unfair means.

Q1.

Which body voided the initial NEET-UG 2026 results?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What name is given to the fraudulent papers that closely mirrored the actual test?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term describes the planned repeat of the examination for candidates?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Along with public trust, what did the voiding of the initial results aim to maintain?

Answer: _____

Q5.

On what kind of platforms was unauthorised exam material circulated?

Answer: _____

Q6.

To whom will the re-test be administered?

Answer: _____

NEET, NTA and the 2024 controversy: typed answers

NEET is the national entrance examination for admission into medical colleges across India. The examination is conducted by the National Testing Agency. In 2024, an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks, and the Ministry of Education later constituted a high-level committee to look into the controversy. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 aims to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. The scope of unfair means includes leakage of question papers or answer keys, candidate impersonation, unauthorised assistance during examinations, tampering with computer systems or networks, conducting fake examinations, and manipulating official documents. Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable. Investigations under the Act are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police. The Central Government may transfer investigations to a Central

Investigating Agency when required. Exam cancellations delay admissions and disrupt the academic calendar for millions of students. Unfair practices cause significant stress, frustration and demotivation for ethical students. Loss of system credibility reduces the market value of degrees and merit rankings. Re-conducting compromised examinations imposes a heavy financial burden on government institutions. Large-scale cheating causes parents and students to lose confidence in educational fairness.

Q1.

In which year was the NTA established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city is the NTA headquartered?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who is the head of the NTA?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which department is the NTA an autonomous body?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which former ISRO Chairman headed the high-level committee set up after the NEET-UG 2024 controversy?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Apart from NEET-UG and CUET, name one other major examination conducted by the NTA.

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did no candidate achieve full marks in NEET-UG?

Answer: _____

Ripple effect of exam malpractice: typed answers

NEET is the national entrance examination for medical colleges across India. The examination is conducted by the National Testing Agency. In 2024, an unusually high number of candidates achieved full marks, and the Ministry of Education later constituted a high-level committee to look into the controversy. NEET 2026 was declared compromised amid allegations of a paper leak, and the examination was officially cancelled. Authorities initiated an investigation after reports surfaced about illicit paper leaks and the circulation of unauthorised exam material. Evidence uncovered by law enforcement formed part of the investigation. The NTA decided to void the initial results to maintain integrity and public trust, and the test will be administered again. The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was introduced to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. Offences under the Act are cognisable, non-bailable and non-compoundable. Investigations are conducted by officers not below the rank of Deputy Superintendent of Police or Assistant Commissioner of Police. The scope of unfair means includes leakage of question papers or answer keys, candidate impersonation, unauthorised assistance during examinations, and tampering with computer systems or networks. Conducting fake examinations and manipulating official documents are also listed as unfair means.

Q1.

What is the booklet's name for the category covering damage to the system and to its institutions?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Loss of system credibility reduces the market value of which two things?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Re-conducting compromised examinations imposes a heavy financial burden on which type of institutions?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Large-scale cheating causes parents and students to lose confidence in what?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Exam cancellations delay which process for millions of students?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Unfair practices cause stress and demotivation for which group of candidates?

Answer: _____

Dates, Names and Places of the Site

The Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Complex is a medieval monument protected by the Archaeological Survey of India. Hindus and Muslims describe the site differently. Tradition links the structure to Raja Bhoj, a ruler whose name is still attached to the building. The term Bhojshala, however, came into use only in the early twentieth century, after inscriptions were found at the site. Traditionally, the site was also regarded as a centre of Sanskrit learning and scholarship.

Later historical records describe a phase of Muslim rule in which the building was reportedly converted into a mosque. Muslims call the structure the Kamal Maula Mosque, a name linked to a Sufi figure. An intricately carved image found during twentieth-century excavations is now kept in a museum abroad, and its location has become part of the wider debate.

An ASI order issued in 2003 had allowed both communities to worship at the site on separate designated days, but the Madhya Pradesh High Court later quashed that order. The case before the court concerned the right to worship at the site. The court also directed the state government to consider applications for suitable alternative land within the town for a mosque or prayer site. The dispute has since been argued in courts and in public discussion.

Q1.

In which year does the booklet date the construction of the building by Raja Bhoj? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the building reportedly converted into a mosque? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which scholar's name is attached to the inscriptions that linked the name Bhojshala to the building? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city is the carved image found at the site now kept? (city)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Sufi saint is associated with the Kamal Maula Mosque? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which city is the monument located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which goddess was the building originally believed to be dedicated to? (name)

Answer: _____

Structure, Dynasty and Verse

The Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Complex contains structural remains, carved pillars and stone slabs that together document parts of its history. The architectural remains point to a hall of a type found in Hindu temple buildings. The site is also known for a set of pillar inscriptions arranged to serve as a learning chart for students of an ancient classical language. The site uniquely preserves this kind of pillar inscription, which makes it a notable example of its type. Verses cut into the walls honour one of the avatars of Lord Vishnu, and they are composed in an ancient Indian language. The inscriptions also name several rulers who governed the region in earlier centuries, which links the complex to a wider political past. The site is additionally associated with the Sanskrit drama Karpuramanjari, which is referenced in its inscriptions. The Archaeological Survey of India holds administrative control over the property, including the management of affairs related to Sanskrit learning at the site. The Madhya Pradesh High Court has declared the site a Hindu temple, based on findings from a survey conducted by the Archaeological Survey of India. The site is also classed as an ancient monument under national heritage law.

Q1.

What type of hall do the architectural remains indicate? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many Sarpabandha pillar inscriptions does the site uniquely preserve? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many tenses and moods of Sanskrit grammar do the Sarpabandha inscriptions chart? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which dynasty's rulers, such as Udayaditya and Naravarman, are named in the inscriptions? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which avatar of Lord Vishnu are the odes on the walls dedicated to? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What was the capital of the Gurjara-Pratihara Empire? (city)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Nagabhata I is listed as the founder of which empire? (name)

Answer: _____

CJI Appointment and Collegium Recall

Judicial appointments in India have been shaped by a series of decisions over several decades. The Constitution provides that judges of the Supreme Court are appointed by the President, and that the Chief Justice of India is appointed after consultation with judges the President considers necessary. For a long period after the Court was set up, the most senior judge was usually chosen to lead the Court as its head. That pattern was broken twice in the 1970s. Later, the Supreme Court interpreted the word consultation in the context of appointments. The Third Judges Case addressed the steps the Chief Justice must take before advising the government. The Second Judges Case addressed the advice tendered by the Chief Justice and the judges he consults. A proposal to create a National Judicial Appointments Commission was made through a constitutional amendment and an Act of Parliament. The Court examined that amendment and Act in 2015. The cases raised questions about the weight to be given to the Chief Justice's view and about the place of the government in appointments. The rulings are commonly known by their ordinal numbers, such as the First and Second Judges Cases. Each judgment discussed here is known by its year and by the question it addressed.

Q1.

Which numbered Constitutional Amendment created the National Judicial Appointments Commission? (give the number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many seniormost Supreme Court judges are ex-officio members of the NJAC? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

When AN Ray was appointed Chief Justice of India in 1973, how many senior judges were superseded? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the Second Judges Case, after consulting how many of his seniormost colleagues does the CJI tender advice? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Union minister is an ex-officio member of the NJAC? (give the designation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In the Second Judges Case, the CJI's advice on appointments was held to be what for the President? (one word)

Answer: _____

Jurisdiction and Temporary Benches Recall

The Supreme Court of India has a few separate routes into its work. Ordinary cases arrive as appeals from lower courts. Some disputes can be filed straight in the Supreme Court because of their nature, such as disputes between the Union and the States. Individuals can also approach the Court directly when their rights are violated. The head of the state may seek the Court's advice on questions of public importance. When the office of the Chief Justice is empty or the Chief Justice cannot act, another judge may take charge. When the Court lacks enough judges to hold a sitting, a High Court judge may be called in temporarily. A retired judge may also be asked to sit for a temporary period. Each of these situations is governed by a specific provision of the Constitution, and the provision must be read with its conditions. The Court's appellate, original and advisory roles together define the scope of its work, and the provisions for temporary arrangements support those roles. Some of these provisions apply to the Chief Justice, while others apply to judges who are not part of the regular bench, and the booklet describes each of them. Each is described with its own conditions.

Q1.

Under which Article can the CJI appoint a High Court judge as an ad hoc judge of the Supreme Court? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Article can a retired Supreme Court or High Court judge be requested to sit as a Supreme Court judge for a temporary period? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Article can the President appoint an Acting Chief Justice of India? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which Article does the Supreme Court have original jurisdiction over disputes between the Government of India and one or more States? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which Article must a High Court certify that a case involves a substantial question of law as to the interpretation of the Constitution, before an appeal can be made to the Supreme Court? (include the suffix)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under Article 127, before the CJI appoints a High Court judge as ad hoc judge, consultation is needed with which Chief Justice? (give the office)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Article can a person approach the Supreme Court directly when Fundamental Rights are violated? (number)

Answer: _____

Origin and Objective: typed-answer practice

Shifting political loyalties after an election has long been a concern in Indian public life. A well-known phrase describes members who changed their allegiance again and again, and the rules discussed here are often named after it. These rules form part of the Constitution and sit in a dedicated schedule, which groups the provisions on the subject together. They were introduced through a constitutional amendment, so they were added to the Constitution rather than passed as an ordinary statute. Two officers play a central role when a complaint is raised under them: the Speaker of the Lok Sabha and the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. Their decisions matter because they determine whether a member keeps a seat. The booklet also records that these decisions have been the subject of concern for some time. The subject has been examined in several Supreme Court judgments, which the booklet lists in its discussion of the topic. Those judgments deal with the powers of presiding officers and the extent to which courts may review their decisions. Taken together, the origin of these rules, their place in the Constitution, and the officers who apply them form the basic background for the topic. The booklet's treatment of the subject is organised into parts that cover its origin, its grounds and its wider significance, and each part adds a different layer to the picture.

Q1.

In which year was the law introduced through a constitutional amendment?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which numbered Constitutional Amendment Act introduced the law? (give the ordinal number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which decade did the phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' become linked with frequent party-switching by legislators? (e.g., 1950s)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What practice is the phrase 'Aaya Ram Gaya Ram' linked to? (two words, hyphen allowed)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the law aim to ensure for governments? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The law aims to prevent political ____ . (one word, plural)

Answer: _____

Grounds for Disqualification: typed-answer practice

A legislator can lose a seat only on grounds set out in a fixed list, not because of ordinary political disagreement. The list covers a member's conduct and personal circumstances. Some grounds concern choices a member makes in relation to a political party, such as conduct in the House. Other grounds concern the member's standing and legal position. Decisions on disqualification are taken by the presiding officer of the house, namely the Speaker of the Lok Sabha or the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. The presiding officer must establish that a ground applies before a seat is lost. Courts can review such decisions in certain circumstances, which is one reason the topic attracts attention. The booklet presents these grounds as a framework that governs when a member's place in the House is at risk. Each ground is a separate condition, and the presiding officer looks at the specific ground that has been alleged. The booklet sets out the grounds one after another, which

makes it possible to check each one on its own terms. A member who is not caught by any listed ground keeps the seat, whatever the political disagreement may be.

Q1.

Being an undischarged ___ is a ground for disqualification of a legislator. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

A legislator declared of ___ mind by a court is liable to disqualification. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Holding an office of ___ is a ground for disqualification. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Showing ___ to another country is a ground for disqualification. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Losing Indian ___ is a ground for disqualification. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

A legislator can be disqualified under any law made by which body? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Voting or abstaining contrary to the party ___ is a ground for disqualification. (one word)

Answer: _____

Significance and Key Issues: typed-answer practice

Rules that govern elected members are often discussed in terms of their purpose and their effect on everyday politics. The booklet describes the framework as one that serves several functions, and it also records the concerns that critics have raised. The framework gives certain officers the job of deciding complaints, and those officers hold their posts within the legislature. Courts have a limited role, since they generally examine a matter only after the relevant officer has ruled on it. Party leaders issue instructions to members, and the booklet describes these instructions as applying in a wide range of situations. The merger provision is another point of discussion, since it allows members to act together in certain circumstances. The booklet also raises the question of how long complaints take to be resolved, which adds to the wider debate. Together these points give the reader a fuller view of how the framework works and why it attracts attention. The rules sit within the Constitution, which gives them a place among its provisions on the conduct of legislators. The booklet sets out the purposes of the framework, the officers who apply it, and the points on which it has drawn criticism, and these are discussed in turn. Several of the points are closely connected, so the reader is best served by seeing how they fit together.

Q1.

The law is said to reinforce democracy and combat what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Adherence to the party whip is said to ensure party _____. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

The law makes legislators ___ for their conduct. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Disqualification petitions often remain ___ for long durations. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The two-thirds merger clause enables large-scale _____. (one word, plural)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Presiding officers may act in a ___ manner, as they often belong to the ruling party. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

The law is said to ensure party ___ and to prevent government instability. (one word)

Answer: _____

Costs of Excessive Forex Conservation (TITA)

The booklet warns that tight control over foreign exchange can have side effects on growth. It says that overly strict controls could stifle manufacturing and broader economic growth, and that Indian industry relies on inputs from abroad for production. Curbing those inputs could reduce output across factories. Capital controls may also change how outsiders view the country, which can hold back the money that would otherwise come in. The booklet points to a past approach as a cautionary example: earlier efforts to cut dependence on foreign goods are said to have resulted in weak industrial performance. Consumption is another channel of concern. Curbs on household spending are seen as a risk to economic growth. Lower production has wider consequences across sectors, and the booklet also warns that a slowdown can weaken the overall economy. The balance, it concludes, must be struck between immediate financial security and the long-term health of industry. The booklet frames these choices as trade-offs that must be made carefully. The booklet's examples come from the current debate over the reserves, which fell to around USD 691 billion by May 2026. Reserves, rupee stability and the cost of imports all feature in this argument. The text also states that imports become more expensive when the rupee weakens.

Q1.

Capital control concerns raise which premium on the country? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Along with FDI, which other type of foreign investment inflow could be dampened? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the past strategy the booklet cites as producing low industrial competitiveness? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Restricted imports lower industrial output and which other variable? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Foreign investors avoid economies lacking strong what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Suppressing private consumption threatens which economic aggregate? (two words)

Answer: _____

How the Press Freedom Index Works

Press freedom refers to the ability of journalists to gather information and publish it without undue pressure. Conditions for this differ widely from one country to another, and the World Press Freedom Index compares them within a single framework. The index ranks countries and regions according to the level of freedom available to journalists. To reach this ranking, it evaluates several aspects of the media environment, including how varied the media are, how independent they remain, and how well the legal system supports them. A central tool in this work is a questionnaire that gathers information on the conditions in which reporters operate. The results are released in a published report that places each country on a list and allows readers to compare nations with one another. Because the report reflects conditions at the time of assessment, a country's position can change when its situation changes. A free press is also described as one that acts independently, promotes transparency and holds powerful people accountable. Journalism therefore has a role beyond the newsroom, since it can give a voice to those who lack institutional power and can highlight injustices that would otherwise go unseen. For this reason, the index serves as a measure of how well journalists are able to do their work.

Q1.

In which year was the organisation that publishes the index founded? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city is the publisher of the index headquartered? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which edition of the index is the 2026 report? (ordinal number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the highest score a country can receive in the index? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

From which year has the index been published as an annual report? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What type of organisation publishes the index? (one word)

Answer: _____

Press Freedom: Challenges and Role

Press freedom is shaped by a number of pressures, and financial strain is among the most widely noted. Media outlets in many countries face financial instability, which can threaten independent and unbiased reporting. Freedom of expression is regarded as vital to preserve journalistic integrity and to prevent undue influence from state or private actors. A free press is described as one that acts independently, promotes transparency and holds powerful people accountable. Its

work reaches beyond the newsroom, since it highlights systemic injustices and enables public participation in democratic discourse through information, critique and civic dialogue. News coverage can also influence discussions in parliamentary and legislative bodies. A widely quoted line makes a similar point in a few words: where the press is free, and every man able to read, all is safe. These roles explain why the press is treated as significant in public life. Taken together, the pressures on the press and the roles it plays help explain why its condition matters to a society as a whole. Independence, transparency and accountability are therefore the qualities by which such a press is described. Freedom of the press is linked to a range of functions, from informing the public to examining those in power.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Indian Constitution is freedom of the press treated as part of freedom of speech? (article number with sub-clause)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In 1950, which Supreme Court case said freedom of the press lies at the foundation of all democratic organisations? (first party's name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

The press is called the fourth pillar of democracy, alongside the legislature, the judiciary and which other organ? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

During the pandemic, media acted as a critical communication tool between government and whom? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Who is the author of the line 'Where the Press is Free, and Every Man able to Read, All is Safe'? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Political instability is linked to a decline in what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Besides local accountability, what social value does community journalism promote? (two words)

Answer: _____

Logistics Programmes and Index Facts

The LEADS 2025 Report was released by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, which sits under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The report appears in the May 2026 current affairs compilation under the heading Summits, Reports, Indices. LEADS is described as India's national index for benchmarking logistics performance across the States and Union Territories. It evaluates each State and UT across key logistics parameters, including infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment, operational efficiency and data-driven logistics reforms.

The 2025 edition introduced a four-tier classification system for States and UTs. Its categories are Exemplars, High Performers, Accelerators and Growth-Seekers. The report sits within a wider set

of national efforts in logistics. One of these is the PM GatiShakti National Master Plan 2021, which appears in the report's list of initiatives. Several other programmes are also listed, and the report describes each briefly as part of the effort to strengthen the sector.

The report notes that logistics costs in India remain relatively high. It also refers to the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index and to India's position in that index for 2023. Separately, the Department conferred the LEAPS Awards 2025 to recognise excellence and innovation in India's logistics sector.

Q1.

What is the approximate share of logistics costs in India's GDP, according to the booklet? (per cent, number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How often does the World Bank report the Logistics Performance Index? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which programme aims to improve road connectivity across India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which programme focuses on port-led development and boosts coastal shipping efficiency? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which system mandates digital bills for goods and eases inter-state transport? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the full name of the programme that aims to enhance freight speed, reduce costs and improve tracking?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which 2022 national policy aims to lower logistics costs to par with other developed countries? (name with year)

Answer: _____

Origin of the day: typed answers

National Technology Day is an observance in India that recognises technological achievement. It is based on a set of milestones that the country reached on one day, and the observance was created to remember them. The occasion is observed every year, and it has been part of the national calendar since its early years. The achievements it recalls belong to different fields of work. Some were linked to nuclear research, some to flight and some to the development of missiles. The observance does not celebrate one invention alone. Its name has stayed the same since the first observance, and the day is treated as a fixed point on the calendar. A national leader of the time gave the day its formal status, which is why the observance is linked to a specific decision rather than a general idea. Another part of the day's background involves the national awards for science, which are announced on the occasion. The day therefore brings together several strands: a historical date, a list of technical milestones, a formal decision by a leader, and a regular annual observance that keeps these achievements in view for the public. Each observance returns attention to the same set of achievements.

Q1.

Which Prime Minister declared 11 May as National Technology Day? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the annual observance of the day begin? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which agency test-fired the Trishul missile on that day? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which aircraft completed its first successful test flight on that day? (name with hyphen)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which desert is the Pokhran test range located? (name of the desert)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What are India's science honours that are announced on the day called? (name of the awards)

Answer: _____

Digital, farm and dairy milestones: typed answers

National Technology Day also highlights India's digital infrastructure and farm and dairy milestones. Digital systems now reach large numbers of people in their everyday lives, and the observance treats them as a major area of progress. Several indices and reports from global bodies are used to discuss how the country performs in innovation and intellectual property. Such reports are referred to in discussions about technological standing, and they are part of the wider picture the observance describes. The day therefore brings together technology in daily life with national performance in research. Its framework covers machines, laboratories and the systems that serve citizens directly. The observance does not focus on a single sector. Instead, it treats digital, agricultural and dairy progress as connected parts of one story about technological development in India. Each year, the day gives the public an occasion to review these areas together and to consider the progress they represent. The areas are varied, but they share the theme of applying technology to national life. This shared focus links the digital, farm and dairy areas in one account.

Q1.

Which identity system is described as the world's largest biometric ID system? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which payment system revolutionised digital payments in India? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which revolution boosted production through high-yielding wheat and rice varieties? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which revolution made India the world's largest milk producer? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which organisation's report is cited for India's intellectual property filings? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Expand the acronym UPI. (full name)

Answer: _____

Institutions and schemes: typed answers

India supports technology through a mix of statutory bodies, national missions and smaller programmes. Some of these arrangements are created by a specific law, while others come from national planning bodies that set priorities for innovation. Schemes aim to help research reach the market, to encourage new ideas among young people and to build capacity in areas such as defence technology and emerging sciences. Some bodies are directed at industry, others at schools and universities, and some work across several areas at once. The national awards for science also form part of this landscape. Each of these bodies has its own focus and its own method of working. The overall picture is one of institutions that complement one another, each with a defined area of work, and that together aim to strengthen national technological capability. Students, researchers and entrepreneurs are among the groups that these programmes are designed to reach. The range of these programmes shows how technology policy in India covers education, research, industry and defence at the same time. Students and schools form one part of this effort, while defence and space form another.

Q1.

Which defence startup scheme's name stands for Innovations for Defence Excellence? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Technology Development Board Act passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which NITI Aayog-launched mission fosters an innovation culture? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which national awards are comparable to the Padma Awards? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which national mission focuses on quantum computing, communication, sensing and materials? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which mission plans a network of world-class supercomputers across premier institutions? (name)

Answer: _____

Origin of International Labour Day: TITA practice

International Labour Day is observed every year in May to honour the contribution of workers across the world. The day is also known as Workers Day or May Day. Its beginnings are linked to the labour movement of the late nineteenth century in the United States, where workers were pressing for shorter working hours. In 1886, a large demonstration took place in America, but it soon went out of hand, and in one city many people were hurt. The incident that followed is

remembered as a turning point and is regarded as the point at which the day began. Several years later, socialist political organisations in another continent agreed to adopt a single date for labour observance. The observance reached India in the early twentieth century, when the first celebration in the country was held in an Indian city by a political group of workers and peasants. The booklet presents the day as a tribute to labour. The theme for 2026 is Ensuring Safety and Health at Work in A Changing Climate, and the observance is therefore linked to that present-day concern.

Q1.

In 1889, Socialist Parties in which continent decided to celebrate May 1 as International Labour Day?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the first May Day celebrated in India?

Answer: _____

Q3.

The first May Day in India was celebrated in which city, then known as Madras?

Answer: _____

Q4.

The 1886 demonstration in America demanded how many hours of work on a daily basis? (number of hours)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the Chicago incident that marked the start of International Labour Day?

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which day of May is International Labour Day observed? (day number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which political party organised the first May Day celebration in India in 1923? (full name)

Answer: _____

ILO objectives, standards and reports: TITA practice

The International Labour Organisation was set up to improve labour conditions and living standards across the world. It is a specialised agency of the United Nations devoted to promoting social justice and internationally recognised human and labour rights, and it is an integral part of the United Nations Human Rights Framework. The organisation pursues several objectives, including promoting fundamental labour rights, creating greater opportunities for women and men, enhancing social protection and strengthening social dialogue. Its international labour standards are drawn up by its constituents, namely governments, employers and workers, and include Conventions, Protocols and Recommendations. One important document is a declaration on fundamental principles and rights at work, which names focus areas such as freedom of association, the elimination of forced labour and the abolition of child labour. The ILO also publishes several key reports, including one focused on wages and another on the world of work.

Q1.

Which ILO convention number deals with Forced Labour? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work amended?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which word describes the ILO structure that gives governments, employers and workers an equal voice? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which ILO convention number deals with Equal Remuneration? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which treaty is listed as the establishment basis of the ILO? (name of the treaty)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which key ILO report focuses on wages? (name of the report)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which ILO convention number deals with the Worst Forms of Child Labour? (give the number)

Answer: _____

India's Partnerships: Vietnam, NZ and SAARC

India and Vietnam have agreed to lift their relationship to a higher strategic level after a state visit by a Vietnamese leader. The two countries have set a trade target for 2030 and plan closer defence ties, including work on advanced defence platforms. Vietnam has also formally joined an Indo-Pacific initiative that India promotes. Military exercises between the two countries also take place.

India has signed a free trade agreement with New Zealand. Such an agreement is a pact between countries that reduces customs duties and liberalises trade, and it provides investment protection and safeguards for intellectual property. In this deal India keeps some sensitive sectors outside its concessions to protect domestic producers, while New Zealand has also made an investment commitment. New Zealand is also a major trading partner for India in Oceania.

The SAARC currency swap framework is a bilateral arrangement between central banks. Members exchange domestic currencies at a predetermined rate and reverse the exchange later, which gives short-term liquidity support. The arrangement also aims to reduce dependence on external borrowing, promote the use of the Indian rupee internationally and strengthen regional financial stability. Such a framework is designed to help member nations in times of short-term financial need.

Q1.

Which Vietnamese leader's state visit preceded the upgrade of India-Vietnam ties? (Give the name.)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the bilateral trade target for 2030, in USD billion?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What defence line of credit did India extend to Vietnam, in USD million?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What percentage of Indian exports to New Zealand have their duties eliminated under the FTA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What percentage of tariff lines does India keep under exclusion in the New Zealand FTA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Over how many years will New Zealand invest USD 20 billion? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the initial tenure of the SAARC currency swap, in months?

Answer: _____

Thucydides Trap, Ebola and Ecocide

A rising power that challenges an established power can end up in conflict, a pattern that a historian's account of an old war helped to describe. Its core idea is that fear and rivalry between powers can make a clash more likely. Modern analysts apply this idea to today's great-power rivalries, though critics stress that it can make war seem more inevitable than it is. Diplomacy, trade ties and international institutions are often cited as ways to reduce the risk of confrontation.

Health authorities have also been busy. The World Health Organization has issued a formal emergency declaration over an Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo. Such a declaration is used when a health risk could spread across borders and needs a coordinated global response. Ebola is a severe and fatal viral disease that can affect humans and primates. The disease was formerly known as Ebola haemorrhagic fever.

Environmental harm is drawing legal attention too. Acts that cause severe, widespread or long-term damage to nature, when committed knowingly or recklessly, are described as ecocide. Examples often cited include the Deepwater Horizon oil spill and large-scale deforestation in the Amazon. Several countries have written this idea into their own laws.

Q1.

What is the name of the historian whose analysis of the Peloponnesian War inspired the Thucydides Trap concept?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Ebola strain is linked to the DR Congo outbreak?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was Ebola first identified?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which 1976 Ebola outbreak site in DR Congo lies near the Ebola River?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which country is Nzara, the site of the other 1976 Ebola outbreak?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which treaty is ecocide not currently recognised as an international crime?

Answer: _____

SCO and IORA: Type-in Answers

This passage covers two regional bodies with interests in Asia and the Indian Ocean. The first is a Eurasian grouping that began as a group of five states. It later expanded, and its membership now includes India and several Central Asian states. Its supreme decision-making body is a Council of Heads of States. The grouping accounts for about 30% of global GDP and about 40% of the world population. Its stated aim is regional cooperation against terrorism, separatism and extremism. Its structures include a regional anti-terrorist body that shares intelligence among members. For India, membership offers a route into a region that geography makes hard to reach directly.

The second is an intergovernmental organisation for countries that border the Indian Ocean. It was established in 1997 and has its secretariat in Mauritius. Its vision came out of a 1995 visit to India by a prominent leader. Its areas of cooperation include maritime safety and security, fisheries management and disaster risk management. A track-based forum, the Indian Ocean Dialogue, brings together policymakers, strategists and maritime stakeholders, and its objectives include maritime security cooperation and regional connectivity. The forum is a Track 1.5 diplomatic platform under the association. It was first launched in Australia in 2013, and India has since hosted several editions.

Q1.

In which year did the grouping become the SCO after Uzbekistan joined?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Shanghai Five formed?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the SCO secretariat located?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which town in Mauritius hosts the IORA secretariat?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Whose 1995 visit to India inspired the vision behind IORA? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q6.

What are the two official languages of the SCO? Give both.

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year, apart from 2014 and 2021, did India host an Indian Ocean Dialogue edition?

Answer: _____

Korea, Komagata Maru and Sikkim: Type-in Answers

Three episodes from the region's history are tied to recent anniversaries. The first concerns the Korean peninsula, which was split into two states after the Second World War. The dividing line has remained a border, and a demilitarised zone runs along it. Soon after the division, troops from one side crossed that line in an invasion that prompted a Security Council condemnation. The fighting ended with an armistice rather than a peace treaty, so the two sides have technically remained at war.

The second episode concerns a Himalayan kingdom whose hereditary monarchs ruled for several centuries. Before its integration, a treaty made it a protectorate, and India controlled its defence, external affairs and communications. Its identity and land rights are protected by a constitutional provision. The territory later became a state of India after a popular vote.

The third episode is a voyage. A ship carried passengers from India towards Canada, where rules required travel directly from the country of origin. Only a few passengers were allowed to disembark, and the ship was eventually sent back. When passengers reached a port near Calcutta, British authorities tried to deport them, and troops opened fire. These events show how wars, migration rules and treaties shaped the status of regions and people.

Q1.

In which year was the Korean Armistice Agreement signed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

On which day and month of 1950 did North Korean troops cross the 38th Parallel? Give the day and month.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which dynasty ruled Sikkim as hereditary monarchs from 1642 to 1975? Give the dynasty name.

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who chartered the Komagata Maru?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many passengers were permitted to disembark at Vancouver? Give the number.

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Constitutional Amendment gave Sikkim Associate State status? Give the ordinal number.

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Article protects Sikkim's cultural identity, land rights and existing laws? Give the article number with its letter.

Answer: _____

CDS, Peacekeeping and Awards: Type-in Answers

The Chief of Defence Staff is a four-star officer who is equivalent in rank to the three service chiefs but functions as a first among equals. The post links the armed forces with civilian political leadership. The officeholder is Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee and is appointed by a cabinet committee chaired by the Prime Minister. The post has no fixed tenure, and the officer may hold office until the age of 65.

The United Nations runs peacekeeping missions that combine military, police and civilian personnel to help countries move from conflict to peace. Peacekeepers are widely known by a distinctive nickname based on their headgear. India is among the largest troop contributors to these missions. In 2025 an Indian officer serving in a peacekeeping mission in Lebanon received a UN gender advocate award. The award recognises work on gender equality in peacekeeping.

Recognition in literature and journalism is also part of the picture. A Mandarin Chinese novel won a major international prize for translated fiction in 2026. The prize is awarded for a work of fiction originally written in a language other than English. Two journalists won a Pulitzer in an illustrated reporting and commentary category for a report on digital arrest scams.

Q1.

Who was appointed the 3rd Chief of Defence Staff from 31 May 2026? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Whom did the new CDS succeed? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q3.

The 2025 gender advocate award recipient served in which UN mission in Lebanon? Give the acronym.

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did UN peacekeeping forces win the Nobel Peace Prize?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which university administers the Pulitzer Prize?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Chief of Defence Staff post created?

Answer: _____

Defence and Border Infrastructure: Typed Answer Practice

The defence sector featured prominently in the May 2026 Ailet Corner section of the booklet. Its opening entry concerns the Kalam & Kavach 3.0 conference, which is described as a high-level platform for discussing India's defence transformation, military modernisation and future preparedness. The booklet gives the conference a short description and lists its main points briefly. Another entry covers the TARA weapon system. The booklet describes it as an indigenous glide weapon, meaning a system developed within India. Several points about the system are listed in short form, including its trial and the agencies that took part in it. Border infrastructure forms the third part of this defence coverage. The Border Roads Organisation is presented as India's premier agency for this work, and its activities are described as taking place in difficult terrain. Project Deepak is listed under the same heading, and the booklet mentions it alongside the organisation's wider work on the country's borders. Each entry is a self-contained point, so the section can be

read in any order. The booklet presents the Kalam & Kavach entry first, followed by the weapon system and then the border infrastructure entries. Short descriptions and headings make each item easy to find on the page.

Q1.

In which year was the Border Roads Organisation established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which ministry organised the Kalam & Kavach 3.0 Defence Conference? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What does the acronym TARA stand for? (full phrase)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which region does Project Deepak operate in? (region name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which city is the headquarters of the Border Roads Organisation located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which edition of the Kalam & Kavach Defence Conference is described in this booklet? (ordinal)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the kit that attaches to an existing unguided warhead to convert it into a precision-guided weapon? (name of kit)

Answer: _____

Governance, Crime Data and Remembrance: Typed Answer Practice

The May 2026 Ailet Corner section of the booklet covers governance, crime data and remembrance. Its first item is a national initiative to build AI skills for the creative sector, launched by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. The initiative aims to strengthen India's creative economy and digital content ecosystem, and its target sectors include media, animation and content creation. An institute working in creative technologies carries out the initiative, which was developed in partnership with Google and YouTube. Its objective is to build AI capabilities that are ready for industry in creative fields. The second item concerns crime data. The National Crime Records Bureau released its Crime in India 2024 report, which the booklet describes as the first edition to include offences registered under a newer criminal code. The booklet gives a short profile of the bureau, covering its origins and its place in the government. The final item recognises a warrior named Veera Pasi, who came from the Pasi community of Uttar Pradesh. Veera Pasi is remembered as a Dalit freedom fighter who took part in a major uprising against British colonial rule, and the booklet notes a recent honour for this figure in Uttar Pradesh. Each heading in the section is kept short, which makes the three items easy to scan.

Q1.

In which year was the National Crime Records Bureau established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which ministry does the National Crime Records Bureau function? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which commander did Veera Pasi serve under? (name of commander)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which town was a statue of Veera Pasi unveiled? (town)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Along with the National Police Commission, whose recommendations form the basis of the National Crime Records Bureau? (committee name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Crime in India 2024 includes offences under which new criminal law, alongside the IPC? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____